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# HUMAN RESOURCES POLICY BINDER

Employment Policies, Procedures & Employee Handbook

**Residential Care Services Division**

**Document Reference**  
ECC-HR-POL-2026-001

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## DOCUMENT INFORMATION

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|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Organization</b>          | Evergreen Community Care Inc.                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Document Title</b>        | Human Resources Policy Binder                                                                                                                                                                |
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| <b>Review Cycle</b>          | Annual (or upon legislative amendment)                                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>Governing Legislation</b> | BC Employment Standards Act; BC Human Rights Code; Workers Compensation Act (WorkSafeBC); BC Labour Relations Code (if applicable); Personal Information Protection Act (PIPA); CFCSA; CCALA |
| <b>Applies To</b>            | All employees, contractors, and volunteers of Evergreen Community Care                                                                                                                       |



## MESSAGE FROM LEADERSHIP

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Welcome to Evergreen Community Care. This Human Resources Policy Binder sets out the employment policies, standards, and expectations that guide our work together. Whether you are new to our team or a long-standing employee, this binder is your reference for navigating your employment relationship with us — from recruitment through to offboarding.

Our work supporting children, youth, and families demands the highest standards of professionalism, integrity, and care. These policies exist not as bureaucratic obligations but as the framework that allows every employee to do their best work in a safe, fair, and supportive environment.

This binder should be read alongside the Evergreen Community Care Residential Care Policy Manual (ECC-RC-POL-2024-001), which governs direct service delivery standards. Where the two documents overlap on matters such as training requirements or critical incident response, both apply.

We encourage every employee to read this binder in full, ask questions, and raise concerns with their supervisor or Human Resources at any time.

**Evergreen Community Care Leadership Team**



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# 1. PURPOSE, SCOPE, AND APPLICATION

## 1.1 Purpose

This Human Resources Policy Binder establishes consistent, fair, and legally compliant employment practices across all Evergreen Community Care operations. It is designed to:

- Set clear expectations for employees and management
- Ensure compliance with BC employment legislation and MCFD contractual requirements
- Support a safe, respectful, and inclusive workplace
- Provide consistent procedures for hiring, performance management, compensation, leave, and termination
- Protect the organization and its employees through clearly documented standards

## 1.2 Scope and Application

This binder applies to:

- All full-time, part-time, and casual/relief employees
- All probationary and permanent employees
- Contractors and consultants, where specified
- Volunteers, where specified
- All Evergreen Community Care facilities and programs in British Columbia

## 1.3 Relationship to Other Policies

This binder works alongside the Evergreen Community Care Residential Care Policy Manual (ECC-RC-POL-2024-001). Direct-care training requirements, critical incident protocols, and child-safety-specific conduct standards are detailed there and incorporated into this binder by reference, particularly in relation to Training (Section 6), Code of Conduct (Section 13), and Health & Safety (Section 16) of this binder.

## 1.4 Policy Administration

|                                   |                                         |
|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Policy Owner</b>               | Director of Human Resources             |
| <b>Approving Authority</b>        | Executive Director / Board of Directors |
| <b>Questions / Interpretation</b> | Human Resources Department              |
| <b>Annual Review</b>              | Each July, or upon legislative change   |



## 2. EMPLOYMENT FOUNDATIONS

### 2.1 Equal Opportunity Employment

Evergreen Community Care is an equal opportunity employer. We recruit, hire, promote, and compensate employees based on qualifications, performance, and organizational need, without discrimination on the basis of race, colour, ancestry, place of origin, religion, marital status, family status, physical or mental disability, sex, sexual orientation, gender identity or expression, age, political belief, or any other ground protected under the BC Human Rights Code.

### 2.2 Employment Categories

| Category            | Definition                                       | Benefit Eligibility                            |
|---------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------|
| Full-Time Permanent | Regularly scheduled 30+ hours/week, ongoing      | Full benefits per Section 9                    |
| Part-Time Permanent | Regularly scheduled under 30 hours/week, ongoing | Pro-rated benefits where applicable            |
| Casual / Relief     | No guaranteed hours; called in as needed         | Statutory entitlements only                    |
| Probationary        | First 6 months of any new permanent position     | Per category above; subject to probation terms |
| Fixed-Term Contract | Employment for a defined period or project       | As specified in contract                       |

### 2.3 Probationary Period

- All new permanent employees serve a probationary period of six (6) months from their start date
- During probation, performance and suitability are formally reviewed at 30, 90, and 180 days
- Employment may be terminated during probation with reduced notice as permitted under the Employment Standards Act
- Probation may be extended by mutual written agreement where additional assessment time is needed

### 2.4 Hours of Work

- Standard full-time hours are 37.5–40 hours per week, as defined by position and schedule
- Residential care shift schedules vary and may include days, evenings, nights, weekends, and statutory holidays
- Overtime is paid in accordance with the BC Employment Standards Act: 1.5x regular wage after 8 hours/day or 40 hours/week, and 2x after 12 hours/day
- All hours worked must be accurately recorded through the organization's timekeeping system

### 2.5 Personnel Records

- Evergreen Community Care maintains a confidential personnel file for each employee



- Files include: application materials, reference checks, criminal record check, offer letter, signed policy acknowledgements, performance evaluations, training records, and disciplinary records
- Employees may request to review their own personnel file by providing reasonable notice to Human Resources
- Personnel records are retained for a minimum of 7 years following termination of employment, per employment standards and CRA requirements
- Access to personnel files is restricted to Human Resources, the employee's direct supervisor, and senior management on a need-to-know basis



## 3. RECRUITMENT AND SELECTION

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### 3.1 Recruitment Principles

Evergreen Community Care recruits employees who demonstrate the values, competencies, and commitment required to support vulnerable children and youth. Recruitment practices are transparent, equitable, and designed to identify the best-qualified candidates.

### 3.2 Job Postings

- All vacant positions are posted internally for a minimum of 5 business days before external posting, except in urgent operational circumstances
- External postings are distributed through job boards, post-secondary institutions, and community networks
- Postings are actively distributed through Indigenous community networks, Friendship Centres, and Indigenous-focused job boards to support our Indigenous hiring strategy
- All postings include accurate role descriptions, required qualifications, and salary range where required by law

### 3.3 Application and Screening

1. Applications are screened against minimum qualifications and core competencies for the role
2. Shortlisted candidates are invited to a structured, competency-based interview
3. Interview panels include a minimum of two staff members wherever possible
4. Core competencies assessed include: trauma-informed care knowledge, cultural safety, de-escalation skills, professional boundaries, judgment, and resilience
5. Practical or scenario-based assessment may be used for direct-care roles

### 3.4 Background Screening Requirements

Prior to any offer being finalized, all candidates for roles involving contact with children or youth must clear:

- A Criminal Record Check (CRC) including Vulnerable Sector Check through the BC Ministry of Public Safety
- Verification of a minimum of two professional references, with at least one from a direct supervisor in a relevant role
- Verification of claimed education, certifications, and professional designations
- Confirmation of legal right to work in Canada

No candidate may begin work with children or youth, even on a supervised basis, until a clear Criminal Record Check has been received and verified.

### 3.5 Indigenous Hiring Strategy

- Evergreen Community Care targets a minimum of 20% Indigenous representation across its residential care workforce
- Indigenous candidates are supported through the hiring process with cultural liaisons available upon request
- Hiring panels positively consider Indigenous lived experience and community connection as relevant qualifications



### **3.6 Internal Promotion and Transfer**

- Current employees in good standing are encouraged to apply for internal postings
- Internal candidates are assessed using the same competency-based process as external candidates
- Lateral transfers may be approved by mutual agreement between the employee, current supervisor, and receiving supervisor

### **3.7 Offer of Employment**

- All offers of employment are made in writing and specify position, compensation, start date, reporting relationship, and probationary terms
- Offers are conditional upon successful completion of background screening and reference checks
- Employees must sign and return the offer letter, along with required policy acknowledgements, prior to their start date



## 4. ONBOARDING AND ORIENTATION

### 4.1 Pre-Employment Requirements

Before a new employee's first shift, the following must be completed and confirmed by Human Resources:

- Clear Criminal Record Check / Vulnerable Sector Check on file
- Signed offer letter and employment agreement
- Signed acknowledgement of this HR Policy Binder and the Residential Care Policy Manual
- Completed payroll and benefits enrollment forms
- Emergency contact information on file
- Confirmation of right to work in Canada (SIN documentation)

### 4.2 Orientation Program

All new employees complete a structured orientation program before working unsupervised with children or youth. Orientation includes:

| Orientation Component                                        | Timing                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|
| Organizational values, mission, and structure                | Day 1                          |
| Review of HR Policy Binder and key employment terms          | Day 1                          |
| Review of Residential Care Policy Manual                     | Week 1                         |
| Mandatory training modules (see Section 6)                   | Within 30–90 days per schedule |
| Facility tour and introduction to team                       | Day 1                          |
| Minimum 3 supervised shifts with an experienced staff member | Weeks 1–2                      |
| Assignment of mentor / buddy                                 | Week 1                         |
| IT systems, timekeeping, and documentation systems setup     | Day 1–2                        |

### 4.3 Probationary Check-Ins

- 30-day check-in: informal review of onboarding experience and early performance
- 90-day check-in: formal performance review against role expectations
- 180-day (end of probation) review: formal decision on confirmation of permanent employment

### 4.4 New Employee Resources

- Each new employee receives a printed or digital copy of this HR Policy Binder and the Residential Care Policy Manual
- New employees are provided contact information for their supervisor, Human Resources, and the Employee Assistance Program
- Login credentials for scheduling, payroll, and documentation systems are provided in the first week



## 5. TRAINING AND PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

### 5.1 Mandatory Training Requirements

All residential care staff must complete required training at orientation and on the renewal schedule below. Training completion is tracked centrally by Human Resources and reviewed monthly. These requirements mirror and incorporate those set out in the Residential Care Policy Manual, Section 19.

| Training                                 | Orientation Deadline              | Renewal                            |
|------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------|------------------------------------|
| First Aid / CPR (Level C)                | Prior to first unsupervised shift | Per certification cycle (~3 years) |
| Non-Violent Crisis Intervention (NVCI)   | Within 90 days                    | Annual recertification             |
| Trauma-Informed Practice                 | Within 60 days                    | Annual refresher                   |
| Indigenous Cultural Safety and Humility  | Within 60 days                    | Annual refresher                   |
| LGBTQ2S+ Inclusion and Cultural Humility | Within 60 days                    | Annual refresher                   |
| Privacy and FOIPPA                       | Within 30 days                    | Annual refresher                   |
| Medication Administration                | Within 60 days (if applicable)    | Annual competency check            |
| Duty to Report (CFCSA)                   | Within 30 days                    | Annual refresher                   |
| WHMIS / Workplace Safety                 | Prior to first shift              | As regulations require             |
| Abuse Prevention and Recognition         | Within 60 days                    | Annual refresher                   |

### 5.2 Training Compliance

- Employees with overdue mandatory training are restricted from independent (unsupervised) shifts until compliant
- Supervisors are responsible for monitoring direct reports' training status
- Human Resources issues monthly compliance reports to the Program Manager and Executive Director
- Repeated failure to complete mandatory training without reasonable cause may result in progressive discipline

### 5.3 Professional Development

- Each employee develops an annual professional development plan in partnership with their supervisor
- Evergreen Community Care provides a minimum of \$500 annually per full-time employee for professional development activities, subject to budget approval
- Priority is given to development in trauma-informed care, Indigenous cultural safety, clinical certifications, and leadership development
- Employees may request support for tuition, conference attendance, or certification costs through their supervisor

### 5.4 Education Leave



- Employees pursuing job-related education may request unpaid education leave of up to 12 months, subject to operational requirements
- Requests must be submitted in writing to Human Resources a minimum of 60 days in advance
- Return-to-work guarantees apply only to leaves approved under this policy



## 6. JOB CLASSIFICATION AND COMPENSATION

### 6.1 Compensation Philosophy

Evergreen Community Care is committed to fair, competitive, and equitable compensation that reflects the skill, responsibility, and demands of residential care work. Compensation is reviewed annually against sector benchmarks and budget capacity.

### 6.2 Job Classification Structure

| Classification Level         | Example Roles                                      | Pay Grade |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Level 1 — Entry              | Residential Support Worker (probationary)          | Grade A   |
| Level 2 — Direct Care        | Residential Care Worker, Youth Care Worker         | Grade B   |
| Level 3 — Senior Direct Care | Senior Youth Care Worker, Shift Lead               | Grade C   |
| Level 4 — Specialized        | Behaviour Support Specialist, Cultural Coordinator | Grade D   |
| Level 5 — Supervisory        | Program Supervisor, Assistant Program Manager      | Grade E   |
| Level 6 — Management         | Program Manager, Director                          | Grade F   |

### 6.3 Pay Administration

- Pay periods are bi-weekly, with payment by direct deposit
- Pay statements detail hours worked, rate, deductions, and accrued leave balances
- Wage increases are reviewed annually as part of the performance review cycle, subject to organizational budget
- Shift premiums apply for evening, night, and weekend shifts as specified in the current wage grid
- Statutory holiday pay is calculated in accordance with the BC Employment Standards Act

### 6.4 Overtime and On-Call Compensation

- Overtime is paid at 1.5x regular wage after 8 hours/day or 40 hours/week, and 2x after 12 hours/day, per the Employment Standards Act
- Employees must obtain supervisor pre-approval for overtime except in emergency circumstances
- On-call compensation is paid per the current on-call premium rate, with overtime rates applying to any hours actually worked while on call

### 6.5 Salary Review and Adjustment

- Annual compensation reviews are conducted alongside performance evaluations
- Adjustments may reflect performance, increased responsibility, cost-of-living, or market conditions
- Promotional increases are determined based on the new role's pay grade and the employee's experience



## 7. PERFORMANCE MANAGEMENT

### 7.1 Philosophy

Performance management at Evergreen Community Care is an ongoing, two-way process aimed at supporting employee growth, ensuring quality care, and recognizing achievement. It is not solely an annual event but a continuous conversation between employee and supervisor.

### 7.2 Probationary Reviews

- Conducted at 30 and 90 days for all new employees, with a final decision at 180 days (see Section 4.3)
- Assess role competency, attendance, conduct, and fit with organizational values
- Employees not meeting expectations receive a documented Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) or, where warranted, are released from employment per probationary terms

### 7.3 Annual Performance Evaluations

- Formal performance evaluations are conducted annually for all confirmed employees, typically aligned with the employee's anniversary date
- Evaluations assess competency across: care standards, cultural safety, teamwork, training compliance, documentation quality, and professional conduct
- Evaluations are a two-way conversation; employees complete a self-assessment and set goals for the coming year
- Completed evaluations are signed by both employee and supervisor and retained in the personnel file
- A template Annual Performance Evaluation form is provided in Appendix C

### 7.4 Performance Rating Scale

| Rating               | Description                                                                    |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Exceeds Expectations | Consistently exceeds role requirements; demonstrates leadership and initiative |
| Meets Expectations   | Consistently meets all role requirements and standards                         |
| Developing           | Meets most requirements; specific areas identified for growth with support     |
| Needs Improvement    | Does not consistently meet role requirements; formal improvement plan required |

### 7.5 Performance Improvement Plans (PIPs)

- Issued when an employee's performance falls below expectations in one or more core areas
- PIPs specify the performance concern, clear expectations, support to be provided, and a defined timeline (typically 30–60 days)
- Progress is reviewed at scheduled check-ins throughout the PIP period
- Failure to achieve PIP goals may result in further progressive discipline, up to and including termination (see Section 14)

### 7.6 Recognition Programs



- Evergreen Community Care recognizes outstanding performance through an Employee of the Quarter program
- Peer-nominated recognition awards are presented at quarterly all-staff meetings
- Years-of-service milestones are recognized at 1, 3, 5, 10, and 15+ years



## 8. EMPLOYEE BENEFITS

### 8.1 Benefits Eligibility

| Benefit                                     | Full-Time Permanent     | Part-Time Permanent                             | Casual / Relief             |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------|
| Extended health & dental                    | Eligible after 3 months | Pro-rated, after 6 months (if 15+ hrs/week avg) | Not eligible                |
| Group life / AD&D insurance                 | Eligible after 3 months | Pro-rated, after 6 months                       | Not eligible                |
| Employee & Family Assistance Program (EFAP) | Eligible immediately    | Eligible immediately                            | Eligible immediately        |
| Pension / Group RRSP matching               | Eligible after 1 year   | Eligible after 1 year (pro-rated)               | Not eligible                |
| Paid vacation                               | Per Section 8.3         | Per Section 8.3 (pro-rated)                     | Statutory vacation pay only |
| Paid sick leave                             | Per Section 8.4         | Per Section 8.4 (pro-rated)                     | Statutory entitlement only  |

### 8.2 Extended Health and Dental

- Coverage includes prescription drugs, paramedical services (massage, physiotherapy, counselling), vision care, and dental care
- Detailed plan booklets are provided by Human Resources upon enrollment
- Employees may add eligible dependents during enrollment or within 30 days of a qualifying life event

### 8.3 Vacation Entitlement

| Years of Service | Annual Vacation Entitlement |
|------------------|-----------------------------|
| Under 5 years    | 3 weeks (15 days)           |
| 5–9 years        | 4 weeks (20 days)           |
| 10+ years        | 5 weeks (25 days)           |

- Vacation entitlement exceeds the BC Employment Standards Act minimum at all service levels
- Vacation requests must be submitted a minimum of 4 weeks in advance and are approved based on operational and staffing needs
- A maximum of 5 unused vacation days may be carried over to the following year with supervisor approval; remaining unused days are paid out per legislation

### 8.4 Paid Sick Leave

- Full-time permanent employees accrue paid sick leave at a rate consistent with BC Employment Standards Act minimums (currently 5 paid sick days per year after 90 days of employment)



- Additional unpaid, job-protected sick leave is available per the Employment Standards Act for longer-term illness or injury
- A doctor's note may be requested for absences exceeding 3 consecutive days
- Unused paid sick days do not carry over year to year and are not paid out upon termination



## 9. STATUTORY AND PROTECTED LEAVES

### 9.1 General Principles

Evergreen Community Care provides all leaves required under the BC Employment Standards Act. These leaves are job-protected, meaning an employee's position (or a comparable position) is preserved during the leave, and seniority continues to accrue.

### 9.2 Leave Entitlements Summary

| Leave Type                              | Duration                                               | Paid / Unpaid                                      |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------|
| Pregnancy Leave                         | Up to 17 weeks                                         | Unpaid (EI maternity benefits may apply)           |
| Parental Leave                          | Up to 61–62 weeks (depending on pregnancy leave taken) | Unpaid (EI parental benefits may apply)            |
| Family Responsibility Leave             | Up to 5 days/year                                      | Unpaid                                             |
| Bereavement Leave                       | Up to 3 days per occurrence                            | Unpaid (paid per Section 9.5 for immediate family) |
| Compassionate Care Leave                | Up to 27 weeks                                         | Unpaid (EI benefits may apply)                     |
| Critical Illness / Injury Leave (child) | Up to 36 weeks                                         | Unpaid (EI benefits may apply)                     |
| Critical Illness / Injury Leave (adult) | Up to 16 weeks                                         | Unpaid (EI benefits may apply)                     |
| Domestic or Sexual Violence Leave       | Up to 10 days + 15 weeks                               | First 5 days paid; remainder unpaid                |
| Reservist Leave                         | Duration of deployment                                 | Unpaid                                             |
| Jury Duty Leave                         | Duration of service                                    | Unpaid                                             |

### 9.3 Pregnancy and Parental Leave

- Employees must provide a minimum of 4 weeks' written notice before beginning pregnancy or parental leave
- Employees are encouraged to apply for Employment Insurance (EI) maternity and parental benefits; Evergreen Community Care does not top up EI benefits unless specified in an individual agreement
- Benefits coverage continues during the leave provided the employee continues to pay their portion of premiums
- Employees returning from leave are reinstated to their former position or a comparable position at the same wage

### 9.4 Family Responsibility Leave

- Up to 5 unpaid days per year for the care, health, or education of an immediate family member
- Reasonable notice should be provided where the need is foreseeable



## 9.5 Bereavement Leave

- Up to 3 days of unpaid leave per the Employment Standards Act for the death of an immediate family member
- Evergreen Community Care provides these 3 days as paid leave for immediate family (spouse, child, parent, sibling) as an enhanced benefit beyond the statutory minimum
- Additional unpaid bereavement leave may be granted at supervisor discretion



## 10. OTHER LEAVE PROVISIONS

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### 10.1 Personal Leave of Absence

- Employees may request an unpaid personal leave of absence for reasons not covered by statutory leave provisions
- Requests are submitted in writing to the supervisor and Human Resources, with reasons and proposed duration
- Approval is at the discretion of management based on operational needs; benefits continuation during personal leave is assessed case by case

### 10.2 Statutory Holidays

Evergreen Community Care recognizes all BC statutory holidays: New Year's Day, Family Day, Good Friday, Victoria Day, Canada Day, BC Day, Labour Day, National Day for Truth and Reconciliation, Thanksgiving, Remembrance Day, and Christmas Day.

- Eligible employees receive statutory holiday pay per the Employment Standards Act formula
- Employees required to work on a statutory holiday due to residential care operational needs receive premium pay (1.5x) plus a substitute day off, or other arrangement per the current wage grid
- Evergreen Community Care formally observes the National Day for Truth and Reconciliation (September 30) with programming that supports staff and youth engagement in truth and reconciliation

### 10.3 Jury Duty and Court Attendance

- Employees summoned for jury duty or subpoenaed as a witness are granted unpaid leave for the duration
- Employees should provide official documentation to Human Resources as soon as possible

### 10.4 Indigenous Cultural and Ceremonial Leave

- Evergreen Community Care recognizes the importance of cultural and ceremonial practices for Indigenous employees
- Employees may request unpaid leave, or use accrued vacation, to participate in significant cultural ceremonies, potlatches, or community events
- Requests are accommodated wherever operationally feasible, with reasonable advance notice

### 10.5 Religious Observance

- Evergreen Community Care accommodates requests for leave or schedule adjustment for religious observances to the point of undue hardship, consistent with the BC Human Rights Code
- Employees should provide as much advance notice as possible



## 11. CODE OF CONDUCT

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### 11.1 General Standards of Conduct

Every Evergreen Community Care employee is expected to conduct themselves with honesty, integrity, and professionalism at all times, both on and off duty, in a manner consistent with our role as caregivers to vulnerable children and youth.

### 11.2 Professional Boundaries

- Staff must maintain clear, professional boundaries with children, youth, and families at all times
- Staff must not develop personal, romantic, or financial relationships with current or former clients
- Staff must not accept significant gifts from or give significant gifts to children, youth, or families in care
- Staff must not use personal social media to connect with children or youth in care, or their families, except through approved organizational channels
- Staff must not be alone with a single youth in circumstances that depart from the facility's supervision protocols, except where required for safety
- Any boundary concern or dual relationship must be disclosed to a supervisor immediately

### 11.3 Confidentiality

- All employees must protect the confidentiality of information about children, youth, families, and coworkers, consistent with FOIPPA and the Residential Care Policy Manual, Section 22
- Confidential information must not be discussed outside of work contexts, including on personal social media
- Confidentiality obligations continue after employment ends
- All new employees sign a Confidentiality Agreement (Appendix B) as a condition of employment

### 11.4 Conflicts of Interest

- Employees must disclose any actual, potential, or perceived conflict of interest to their supervisor
- Examples include: personal relationships with clients or their families, financial interests in vendors, or secondary employment that conflicts with job duties
- Undisclosed conflicts of interest may result in disciplinary action

### 11.5 Use of Technology and Social Media

- Organizational technology (computers, phones, email) is provided for business use; incidental personal use should be minimal and not interfere with duties
- Employees must not post photos, names, or identifying information about children or youth in care on personal social media
- Employees must not make disparaging public comments about the organization, colleagues, or clients on any platform



- Employees should exercise discretion in all public-facing communications, recognizing their role as a representative of Evergreen Community Care

### **11.6 Substance Use**

- Employees must not be under the influence of alcohol, cannabis, or non-prescribed drugs while on duty
- Employees must not consume alcohol or cannabis on Evergreen Community Care premises, except at organization-sanctioned events for employees only (never in the presence of children or youth)
- Employees taking prescribed medication that may impair judgment or reaction time must disclose this to their supervisor
- Violation of this policy may result in immediate suspension pending investigation

### **11.7 Attire and Presentation**

- Employees are expected to dress in a manner that is professional, practical for the physical demands of the role, and appropriate for working with children and youth
- Facility-specific dress code guidance is provided by the Program Manager



## 12. ANTI-HARASSMENT, ANTI-DISCRIMINATION, AND RESPECTFUL WORKPLACE

### 12.1 Policy Statement

Evergreen Community Care is committed to providing a workplace free from harassment, discrimination, bullying, and violence. This policy applies to all interactions among employees, and between employees and clients, families, contractors, and members of the public.

### 12.2 Definitions

| Term               | Definition                                                                                                                                                 |
|--------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Harassment         | Unwelcome conduct, comment, or display that is known or ought reasonably to be known to be unwelcome and that demeans, humiliates, or embarrasses a person |
| Discrimination     | Adverse treatment of a person based on a protected ground under the BC Human Rights Code                                                                   |
| Sexual Harassment  | Unwelcome conduct of a sexual nature that detrimentally affects the work environment or leads to adverse job-related consequences                          |
| Bullying           | Repeated, unwanted behaviour that demeans, humiliates, or intimidates, excluding reasonable management action                                              |
| Workplace Violence | Any threat, attempt, or act of physical force that causes or could cause injury                                                                            |

### 12.3 Reporting Procedures

6. An employee who experiences or witnesses harassment, discrimination, bullying, or violence should report it to their supervisor, Human Resources, or, where the concern involves their supervisor, to the next level of management or the Executive Director
7. Reports may be made verbally or in writing; a written record will be created regardless of how the report is received
8. Reports are taken seriously and investigated promptly, fairly, and as confidentially as circumstances allow
9. Investigations are typically completed within 10 business days; complex matters may take longer, with the complainant kept informed of timeline
10. Interim measures (e.g., schedule changes, temporary separation) may be implemented during an investigation to ensure safety

### 12.4 No Retaliation

Evergreen Community Care strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who reports harassment or discrimination in good faith, participates in an investigation, or supports a colleague in making a complaint. Retaliation is itself grounds for disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

### 12.5 False Complaints

While all complaints are taken seriously, knowingly making a false complaint is a serious matter and may result in disciplinary action. This does not apply to complaints made in good faith that are not substantiated through investigation.



## 12.6 Outcomes

- Where a complaint is substantiated, consequences may range from coaching and training to progressive discipline, up to and including termination, depending on severity
- Both the complainant and respondent are informed of the investigation outcome to the extent appropriate given privacy considerations
- Employees may also pursue a complaint with the BC Human Rights Tribunal or WorkSafeBC independent of an internal investigation



## 13. PROGRESSIVE DISCIPLINE

### 13.1 Purpose and Philosophy

Progressive discipline is intended to correct performance or conduct issues through a fair, consistent, and escalating process, giving employees a genuine opportunity to improve. Evergreen Community Care follows progressive discipline except where conduct is severe enough to warrant immediate suspension or termination (see Section 13.5).

### 13.2 Standard Progressive Discipline Steps

| Step   | Action                                                                                            | Documentation                                                        |
|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Step 1 | Verbal Warning — informal discussion of the concern, expectations for improvement                 | Brief note to file                                                   |
| Step 2 | Written Warning — formal documentation of the issue, expectations, and consequences of recurrence | Signed written warning in personnel file                             |
| Step 3 | Final Written Warning / Performance Improvement Plan                                              | Signed PIP with defined timeline and consequences                    |
| Step 4 | Suspension (with or without pay, depending on circumstances) or Termination                       | Formal documentation; HR and Executive Director involvement required |

### 13.3 Factors Considered

- Severity and nature of the issue
- Whether the conduct involved risk to a child, youth, or coworker
- The employee's overall performance and disciplinary history
- Whether the conduct was a single incident or a pattern
- Mitigating or aggravating circumstances

### 13.4 Process Rights

- Employees are informed of the specific concern prior to any disciplinary meeting
- Employees may request union or support-person representation where applicable
- Employees are given the opportunity to respond and provide their perspective before a final decision is made
- All disciplinary actions are documented in writing and placed in the employee's personnel file

### 13.5 Immediate Suspension or Termination (Bypassing Progressive Steps)

Certain conduct is serious enough to warrant immediate suspension pending investigation, or immediate termination, without progressing through the standard steps. This includes, but is not limited to:

- Any act or suspected act of abuse, neglect, or exploitation of a child or youth
- Violation of the Restrictive Practices Policy (e.g., use of prohibited restraint or seclusion)
- Being under the influence of drugs or alcohol while on duty
- Theft, fraud, or financial misconduct
- Workplace violence or serious threats



- Falsification of records, including incident reports or care documentation
- Breach of confidentiality involving sensitive child protection information
- Failure to report suspected child abuse as required under the CFCSA
- Criminal charges or convictions relevant to the role

### **13.6 Investigation Process for Serious Allegations**

11. Employee is placed on administrative leave (paid, pending investigation) where the allegation involves potential harm to a child or youth
12. MCFD is notified immediately per the Abuse Prevention and Protection Policy and applicable critical incident timelines
13. An internal investigation is conducted by Human Resources and/or an external investigator, as warranted
14. The employee is given an opportunity to respond to the allegations as part of a fair process
15. A decision is made based on the investigation findings, balance of probabilities, and organizational policy
16. Outcomes may include return to work, reassignment, termination, or referral to external authorities



## 14. EMPLOYEE WELLNESS

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### 14.1 Commitment to Wellness

Evergreen Community Care recognizes that working with traumatized children and youth is demanding and meaningful work that can also lead to vicarious trauma, compassion fatigue, and burnout. We are committed to actively supporting the mental, physical, and emotional well-being of every employee.

### 14.2 Employee and Family Assistance Program (EFAP)

- All employees and their immediate family members have access to a confidential Employee and Family Assistance Program from their first day of employment
- EFAP services include counselling, legal advice, financial counselling, nutrition consultation, and crisis support
- Services are available 24/7 by phone, and many offer virtual or in-person counselling sessions
- Use of the EFAP is confidential; Evergreen Community Care does not receive information about who accesses services or why
- EFAP contact information is posted in all staff areas and provided during orientation

### 14.3 Reflective Supervision and Peer Support

- Monthly reflective supervision sessions are provided to all residential care staff, separate from performance management
- Peer support programs connect employees with trained peer supporters for informal debriefing
- Team debriefs are held following significant incidents or particularly difficult shifts

### 14.4 Critical Incident Stress Management

- Following any critical incident involving significant distress (e.g., serious injury, death, violent incident), all involved staff receive a structured debrief within 48 hours
- Debriefs are facilitated by the Program Manager or an external clinician as appropriate
- Staff are not returned to high-demand duties without adequate support following a critical incident
- Voluntary referral to additional clinical or trauma-focused counselling is available following significant incidents, at organizational expense

### 14.5 Workload and Burnout Prevention

- Schedules are designed to provide adequate rest between shifts, consistent with the Employment Standards Act
- Supervisors monitor for signs of burnout and proactively check in with staff carrying high-acuity caseloads
- Employees are encouraged to use their full vacation entitlement each year
- Mandatory overtime is avoided wherever possible; voluntary overtime sign-up systems are used for shift coverage

### 14.6 Physical Wellness



- Extended health benefits include coverage for massage therapy, physiotherapy, and other paramedical services
- Ergonomic assessments are available upon request for office-based roles
- Staff rooms are equipped with rest areas appropriate for shift-based work



## 15. OCCUPATIONAL HEALTH AND SAFETY PROGRAM

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### 15.1 Policy Statement

Evergreen Community Care is committed to providing a safe and healthy work environment for all employees, in compliance with the Workers Compensation Act and WorkSafeBC Occupational Health and Safety Regulation. Health and safety is a shared responsibility between the organization and every employee.

### 15.2 Roles and Responsibilities

#### Employer Responsibilities

- Provide a safe workplace, equipment, and training
- Establish and maintain an Occupational Health and Safety (OHS) Program appropriate to the size and risk profile of the organization
- Investigate all workplace incidents and near-misses
- Maintain a Joint Health and Safety Committee (JHSC) where required by regulation (20+ employees)
- Provide Workers Compensation coverage for all eligible employees

#### Employee Responsibilities

- Follow all safe work procedures and use required personal protective equipment
- Report hazards, unsafe conditions, and incidents promptly
- Participate in required health and safety training
- Refuse unsafe work and report the refusal to a supervisor immediately (see Section 15.6)

### 15.3 Joint Health and Safety Committee (JHSC)

- Evergreen Community Care maintains a Joint Health and Safety Committee with equal representation from management and workers
- The JHSC meets monthly to review incidents, conduct workplace inspections, and recommend improvements
- Worker representatives are selected by their co-workers or their union, where applicable
- JHSC meeting minutes are posted for employee access

### 15.4 Workplace Violence Prevention

Given the nature of residential care work, Evergreen Community Care maintains a specific Workplace Violence Prevention Program that includes:

- Risk assessment of all facilities and roles for violence exposure
- Mandatory Non-Violent Crisis Intervention (NVCi) training for all direct-care staff
- Personal safety protocols, including check-in systems for staff working alone or in higher-risk situations
- Mandatory reporting and investigation of all violent incidents, including those involving clients
- Post-incident support per Section 14.4

### 15.5 Incident Reporting and Investigation



17. Any workplace injury, illness, or incident (including near-misses) must be reported to a supervisor immediately
18. Supervisor ensures immediate first aid or medical attention as needed
19. An Incident Investigation Report (Appendix D) is completed within 24 hours for all incidents
20. Serious incidents (as defined by WorkSafeBC, including death, major injury, or major structural failure) are reported to WorkSafeBC immediately and the scene preserved
21. The JHSC reviews all incident investigation reports and recommends corrective action
22. Corrective actions are tracked to completion by the Program Manager

### **15.6 Right to Refuse Unsafe Work**

Every employee has the right to refuse work they have reasonable cause to believe is unsafe to themselves or others. The process is:

23. Employee reports the unsafe condition to their supervisor immediately
24. Supervisor investigates in the presence of the employee and a worker JHSC representative where possible
25. If the hazard is confirmed, corrective action is taken before work resumes
26. If there is disagreement about whether the work is unsafe, a WorkSafeBC officer may be contacted to make a determination
27. No employee will face retaliation for a good-faith work refusal

### **15.7 Workers Compensation Claims**

- Employees injured at work are supported to file a WorkSafeBC claim promptly
- Evergreen Community Care cooperates fully with WorkSafeBC claims processes and return-to-work planning
- A Return-to-Work Coordinator supports injured employees through modified duties and graduated return to full duties

### **15.8 Workplace Inspections**

- Formal workplace inspections are conducted monthly by the JHSC at each facility
- Inspections cover physical safety, fire safety equipment, first aid supplies, and general hazard identification
- Inspection findings and corrective actions are documented and tracked



## 16. GENERAL HEALTH AND SAFETY PROVISIONS

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### 16.1 First Aid

- Each facility maintains a stocked first aid kit, inspected monthly
- A minimum number of staff on each shift hold current Occupational First Aid or Level C certification, per facility risk assessment
- All workplace injuries, however minor, are logged in the first aid record book

### 16.2 WHMIS (Workplace Hazardous Materials Information System)

- All employees complete WHMIS training prior to their first shift
- Safety Data Sheets (SDS) for all hazardous products used on-site are accessible to all staff
- Hazardous products are stored, labeled, and used per WHMIS and manufacturer requirements

### 16.3 Personal Protective Equipment (PPE)

- Appropriate PPE (gloves, masks, etc.) is provided at no cost to employees for tasks requiring it
- Staff are trained in correct use and disposal of PPE

### 16.4 Driving and Vehicle Safety

- Employees driving organizational vehicles or transporting clients must hold a valid BC driver's license and provide a current driver's abstract annually
- Use of personal cell phones while driving is prohibited except hands-free for essential calls
- Vehicles are maintained per manufacturer schedules; defects must be reported immediately

### 16.5 Working Alone or in Isolation

- Roles or shifts involving working alone are identified through risk assessment
- Check-in protocols are established for any staff working alone, with defined check-in intervals
- Personal safety devices (e.g., phone, alarm) are provided where risk assessment indicates need



## 17. EMPLOYEE GRIEVANCE AND DISPUTE RESOLUTION

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### 17.1 Purpose

Evergreen Community Care is committed to resolving workplace concerns fairly, promptly, and at the lowest possible level. This procedure provides a clear path for employees to raise concerns about working conditions, application of policy, or treatment by management, separate from harassment and discrimination complaints addressed under Section 12.

### 17.2 Informal Resolution

- Employees are encouraged to first raise concerns directly with their immediate supervisor
- Most concerns can be resolved informally through open conversation
- Employees uncomfortable raising a concern with their direct supervisor may approach Human Resources or the next level of management

### 17.3 Formal Grievance Procedure

28. Step 1: Employee submits a written grievance to their supervisor describing the issue, relevant facts, and desired resolution, within 20 business days of the event
29. Step 2: Supervisor responds in writing within 10 business days
30. Step 3: If unresolved, the employee may escalate in writing to the Program Manager within 10 business days of the Step 2 response
31. Step 4: Program Manager investigates and responds in writing within 10 business days
32. Step 5: If still unresolved, the employee may escalate to the Executive Director for final internal review

### 17.4 Unionized Employees

Where employees are covered by a collective agreement, the grievance procedure set out in that agreement governs, and this section applies only to the extent it does not conflict with the collective agreement.

### 17.5 External Recourse

- Employees retain the right to file a complaint with the BC Employment Standards Branch, the BC Human Rights Tribunal, or WorkSafeBC at any time, independent of internal procedures
- Use of the internal grievance procedure is not a prerequisite to accessing external recourse

## 18. OFFBOARDING AND TERMINATION OF EMPLOYMENT

### 18.1 Types of Employment Separation

| Separation Type                 | Description                                                     |
|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| Resignation                     | Employee-initiated voluntary departure                          |
| Retirement                      | Voluntary departure upon retirement                             |
| Termination Without Cause       | Employer-initiated, with notice or pay in lieu per ESA/contract |
| Termination With Cause          | Employer-initiated due to serious misconduct, without notice    |
| Layoff                          | Employer-initiated due to operational/funding requirements      |
| End of Probation (Unsuccessful) | Employment ends during or at end of probationary period         |
| End of Fixed-Term Contract      | Natural expiry of a defined-term contract                       |

### 18.2 Employee Resignation

- Employees are asked to provide a minimum of two weeks' written notice of resignation (four weeks for supervisory/management roles)
- Resignation should be submitted in writing to the direct supervisor and Human Resources
- Exit interviews are offered to all departing employees to gather feedback

### 18.3 Termination Without Cause

- Where employment is terminated without cause, the employee receives written notice or pay in lieu of notice, calculated per the BC Employment Standards Act minimums or the employee's written employment contract, whichever is greater

| Length of Service | Minimum Notice / Pay in Lieu (ESA) |
|-------------------|------------------------------------|
| 3 months – 1 year | 1 week                             |
| 1 – 3 years       | 2 weeks                            |
| 3 – 4 years       | 3 weeks                            |
| 4 – 5 years       | 4 weeks                            |
| 5 – 6 years       | 5 weeks                            |
| 6 – 7 years       | 6 weeks                            |
| 7 – 8 years       | 7 weeks                            |
| 8+ years          | 8 weeks                            |

Note: Individual employment contracts, common law reasonable notice, or group termination provisions may provide for greater entitlements than the ESA minimums shown above. Legal advice should be sought for any termination involving complex circumstances.

### 18.4 Termination With Cause



- Termination with cause is reserved for serious misconduct that fundamentally breaches the employment relationship (see Section 13.5 for examples)
- No notice or severance is owed under the Employment Standards Act where just cause is established
- All terminations with cause are reviewed by Human Resources and, where appropriate, legal counsel, prior to being finalized, to ensure the standard for cause is met

## 18.5 Layoff

- Layoffs due to funding changes or operational restructuring follow Employment Standards Act requirements for group terminations where applicable (50+ employees terminated within a 2-month period)
- Selection for layoff is based on objective operational criteria; seniority may be a factor where specified in a collective agreement
- Recall rights, where applicable, are detailed in the layoff notice



## 19. OFFBOARDING PROCESS AND CHECKLIST

### 19.1 Final Pay

- Final pay, including all outstanding wages, accrued vacation pay, and statutory entitlements, is issued within the timeline required by the BC Employment Standards Act (within 48 hours of termination if terminated by employer; within 6 days if employee resigns)
- A Record of Employment (ROE) is issued within 5 calendar days of the interruption of earnings

### 19.2 Return of Property

- Departing employees must return all organizational property: keys, access cards, devices, uniforms, documents, and any client-related materials
- IT access (email, scheduling systems, documentation systems) is deactivated on the employee's last working day

### 19.3 Benefits Wind-Down

- Extended health and dental benefits end on the last day of employment or the end of the applicable benefit month, per the group benefits plan
- Information on benefits conversion options is provided to departing employees where available
- Pension/RRSP matching contributions cease as of the final pay period; employees receive information on their account options

### 19.4 Offboarding Checklist

| Task                                                              | Responsible Party   |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|
| Confirm last day of work and separation type                      | Supervisor / HR     |
| Conduct exit interview (if applicable)                            | Human Resources     |
| Collect keys, access cards, devices, uniforms                     | Supervisor          |
| Deactivate IT/system access                                       | IT / Administration |
| Process final pay and vacation payout                             | Payroll             |
| Issue Record of Employment (ROE)                                  | Payroll / HR        |
| Provide benefits continuation/conversion information              | Human Resources     |
| Update personnel file with separation documentation               | Human Resources     |
| Notify MCFD of staffing change if relevant to a child's care team | Program Manager     |

### 19.5 References

- Evergreen Community Care provides factual employment verification (dates of employment, position held) for all former employees upon request
- Detailed references regarding performance are provided only with the former employee's written consent, and only by their direct supervisor or Human Resources



- No reference will be provided that includes confidential personnel information without consent



## 3A. REFERENCE CHECK POLICY

### 3A.1 Purpose

This policy establishes consistent, equitable, and legally compliant procedures for verifying candidate references as part of Evergreen Community Care's recruitment process for all positions.

### 3A.2 Policy Statement

Reference checks are mandatory before any offer of employment is finalized. No candidate may commence employment until at least two professional references have been verified and documented.

### 3A.3 Minimum Reference Requirements

| Requirement                  | Standard                                                                   |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Minimum number of references | Two (2) professional references                                            |
| Required type                | At least one (1) must be a direct supervisor or manager in a relevant role |
| Recency                      | At least one reference from employment within the past five (5) years      |
| Character references         | Not accepted in lieu of professional; may supplement as a third reference  |
| Candidate consent            | Written consent obtained before any reference is contacted                 |

### 3A.4 Reference Check Process

- The recruiting supervisor or Human Resources contacts references by telephone using a standardized reference questionnaire
- Questions focus on job-related competencies: reliability, judgment, professional boundaries, trauma-informed practice, teamwork, and suitability for working with vulnerable youth
- Questions about age, family status, religion, disability, or any other ground protected under the BC Human Rights Code are strictly prohibited
- Reference check notes are documented in writing and retained as part of the candidate's recruitment file
- Where a reference raises significant concerns, Human Resources and the hiring supervisor review the information jointly before a final decision is made

### 3A.5 Record Retention

Reference check records are retained in the employee's personnel file for the duration of employment and for seven (7) years following separation, consistent with CRA and employment records requirements.



## **3B. OFFER OF EMPLOYMENT AND EMPLOYMENT CONTRACT POLICY**

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### **3B.1 Purpose**

This policy ensures all employment offers made by Evergreen Community Care are clear, complete, legally compliant, and consistently administered across all programs and positions.

### **3B.2 Written Offer Requirement**

All offers of employment are made in writing. A verbal offer may be extended as a courtesy, but a written offer letter must be provided within two (2) business days and signed by the candidate before employment commences. No candidate may begin work without a signed offer letter on file.

### **3B.3 Required Content of the Offer Letter**

- Position title, classification level, and reporting relationship
- Employment category (full-time, part-time, casual/relief, fixed-term) and expected hours of work
- Start date and primary work location or program assignment
- Compensation: hourly rate or annual salary, applicable shift premiums, and pay period
- Probationary period terms and duration (six months for all new permanent positions)
- Conditions of the offer: clear Criminal Record Check, credential verification, and right to work in Canada
- Reference to the HR Policy Binder and Residential Care Policy Manual as governing employment terms
- Benefit eligibility category and anticipated effective date

### **3B.4 Conditional Offers**

All offers for positions involving contact with children or youth are conditional upon receipt of a clear Vulnerable Sector Criminal Record Check. No candidate may begin working with children or youth, even on a supervised basis, until the clear CRC is confirmed on file with Human Resources.

### **3B.5 Fixed-Term Contracts**

Fixed-term contracts must specify start and end dates, the reason for the fixed term, compensation terms, and the terms of any renewal. Fixed-term employees do not have a right of renewal unless explicitly stated in writing. Fixed-term employees whose contract is renewed more than twice in the same role may trigger employment standards review for continuous employment status.

### **3B.6 Signing Authority**

Offer letters and employment contracts are signed by the Director of Human Resources or the Executive Director. Program Managers and supervisors do not have authority to make verbal or written employment commitments outside this formal process. Any unauthorized verbal offer is not binding on the organization.



## 3C. CONTRACTOR AND CONSULTANT ENGAGEMENT POLICY

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### 3C.1 Purpose

This policy governs the engagement of independent contractors, consultants, and agency-placed workers to ensure legal compliance with CRA worker classification rules, BC employment standards, and Evergreen Community Care's child safety obligations.

### 3C.2 Scope

This policy applies to all individuals engaged to perform work for Evergreen Community Care who are not employees, including independent contractors, consulting firms, agency-placed or contract staff, practicum students supervised by external institutions, and service vendors with regular site access.

### 3C.3 Worker Classification

Evergreen Community Care complies with CRA and Employment Standards Act guidelines on the distinction between employees and contractors. Where the nature of an engagement reflects an employment relationship (regular direction and control, organizational equipment, economic dependence), the individual must be engaged as an employee. Human Resources and Finance review all contractor arrangements annually to confirm correct classification and avoid misclassification liability.

### 3C.4 Child Safety Requirements

Any contractor, consultant, or agency-placed worker who will have unsupervised access to children or youth must, prior to commencing work on-site:

- Provide a clear Vulnerable Sector Criminal Record Check dated within twelve (12) months
- Sign Evergreen Community Care's Confidentiality Agreement (Appendix B)
- Complete the Child Abuse Recognition and Duty to Report orientation (minimum 30 minutes)
- Acknowledge the organization's Restrictive Practices Policy and mandatory reporting obligations in writing

### 3C.5 Written Service Agreements

All contractor and consultant engagements exceeding \$2,500 or lasting longer than thirty (30) days require a written service agreement. Agreements must specify: scope of work, deliverables, timeline, fee structure, confidentiality obligations, intellectual property ownership, and termination provisions. Agreements are approved by the Executive Director before work commences.

### 3C.6 Approval and Signing Authority

Contractor agreements are signed by the Executive Director. Program Managers may not commit the organization to contractor or consultant services without prior Executive Director approval and a signed service agreement. Unauthorized verbal engagements are not binding on the organization.



## 5A. OVERTIME AND LIEU TIME POLICY

### 5A.1 Purpose

This policy establishes Evergreen Community Care's practices for managing overtime hours and time off in lieu (lieu time) in a manner that is fair, compliant with the BC Employment Standards Act, and supportive of employee health and wellness.

### 5A.2 Overtime Entitlement

Overtime entitlement is calculated in accordance with the BC Employment Standards Act, as follows:

| Overtime Situation                                        | Rate Payable                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Hours worked beyond 8 hours in a day (up to 12 hours/day) | 1.5 times regular wage                               |
| Hours worked beyond 12 hours in a single day              | 2.0 times regular wage                               |
| Hours worked beyond 40 hours in a work week               | 1.5 times regular wage                               |
| Statutory holiday work                                    | Regular pay plus applicable stat holiday pay per ESA |

### 5A.3 Pre-Approval Requirement

Overtime must be pre-approved in writing (or confirmed in writing following verbal approval) by the employee's supervisor before overtime hours are worked, except in emergency operational circumstances where children or youth would otherwise be left without adequate supervision. In such cases, the supervisor must be notified of the emergency overtime within twenty-four (24) hours.

### 5A.4 Banking Overtime as Lieu Time

By written agreement between the employee and the organization, overtime may be banked as paid time off in lieu at the applicable overtime rate (e.g., 1.5 hours of time off per each hour of overtime worked at the time-and-a-half rate). The following conditions apply to lieu time banks:

- Lieu time must be taken within three (3) months of being earned, or the equivalent overtime pay is issued on the next regular pay statement
- Scheduling of lieu time is by mutual agreement between the employee and supervisor, subject to operational requirements
- Outstanding lieu time balances are shown on each employee pay statement
- Any unused lieu time balance is paid out at the applicable overtime rate upon separation from employment

### 5A.5 Casual and Relief Employees

Casual and relief employees receive overtime pay on the same daily and weekly basis as permanent employees. Because casual employees have no guaranteed minimum hours, the 40-hour weekly threshold is assessed based on hours actually worked in the calendar week, not against a scheduled minimum.



## 5A.6 Scheduling and Rest Periods

Schedules are designed to provide employees with a minimum of eight (8) consecutive hours free from work between shifts. Supervisors must not create schedules that deny employees adequate rest between shifts on a regular basis, as this constitutes a WorkSafeBC fatigue-related hazard and increases the risk of errors in care delivery.



## 5B. MILEAGE AND VEHICLE USE POLICY

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### 5B.1 Purpose

This policy governs the safe, accountable, and legally compliant use of organizational vehicles and the reimbursement of employees who use personal vehicles for authorized work purposes on behalf of Evergreen Community Care.

### 5B.2 Use of Organizational Vehicles

- Organizational vehicles are to be used for work-related purposes only; personal use is not permitted without written prior authorization from the Executive Director
- All drivers of organizational vehicles must hold a valid BC Class 5 or higher driver's licence and must submit an annual driver's abstract to Human Resources each January
- Vehicles must not be operated by any person who has consumed alcohol within the preceding eight (8) hours, or cannabis or controlled substances within the preceding twelve (12) hours
- No vehicle may be operated while the driver is taking prescription or over-the-counter medication that warns against operating machinery or motor vehicles
- All vehicle occupants must wear seatbelts at all times; the driver is responsible for confirming all passengers are belted before moving the vehicle
- Mobile phones must not be held or handled while driving; hands-free devices may be used only where the call is essential to the operation
- Any accident, collision, or vehicle damage involving an organizational vehicle must be reported to the supervisor immediately and documented on the Vehicle Incident Report form within twenty-four (24) hours

### 5B.3 Transporting Children and Youth

When transporting children or youth in organizational or authorized personal vehicles, the following additional requirements apply in all circumstances:

- Age and weight-appropriate child restraints (car seats, booster seats) must be used per BC Motor Vehicle Act requirements
- A minimum of one staff member in addition to the driver must be present when transporting more than two children or youth, or when any child presents elevated behavioural or safety needs identified in their care plan
- A transport log must be completed for every trip involving children or youth, recording: date, origin, destination, purpose, driver name, names of youth passengers, and departure and return times
- Youth must never be left unattended in a vehicle

### 5B.4 Personal Vehicle Use and Mileage Reimbursement

Employees who are authorized in advance to use a personal vehicle for work-related travel are reimbursed at the current CRA prescribed mileage rate, updated annually each January. To claim mileage reimbursement:

- Supervisor pre-approval must be obtained before using a personal vehicle for work travel



- The employee must maintain personal automobile insurance with a minimum of \$2,000,000 third-party liability coverage; the employee is responsible for confirming their policy's business use provisions with their insurer
- A completed mileage log must accompany each expense reimbursement claim, recording: date, origin, destination, business purpose, and kilometres driven
- Travel between an employee's home and their primary regular workplace is commuting and is not eligible for mileage reimbursement



## 5C. SECONDARY EMPLOYMENT POLICY

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### 5C.1 Purpose

Evergreen Community Care respects employees' right to hold secondary employment or self-employment outside of their role with the organization. This policy ensures that secondary employment does not create conflicts of interest, compromise the confidentiality of children or youth in care, or impair an employee's ability to fulfil their primary responsibilities safely.

### 5C.2 Disclosure Requirement

Employees must disclose secondary or self-employment to Human Resources in writing where it meets any of the following conditions:

- Employment or self-employment with another residential care, foster care, child welfare, or social services organization in British Columbia
- Any role that involves the care, support, supervision, or professional relationship with current Evergreen Community Care clients or their immediate family members
- Any role involving a former client within two years of their last date of service with Evergreen Community Care
- Cumulative work hours across all employment that may cause the employee to work more than sixty (60) hours in any given work week, potentially affecting fitness for duty
- Any business or contractual relationship with vendors, contractors, or services providers used by Evergreen Community Care

### 5C.3 Review and Approval

Human Resources and the Program Manager review all disclosures within ten (10) business days and confirm in writing whether a conflict exists. Where no conflict is identified, no further action is required beyond the disclosure being filed. Where a potential conflict is identified, the employee is required to resolve it prior to returning to independent shifts.

### 5C.4 Prohibited Secondary Employment

Employees may not hold secondary employment that directly conflicts with Evergreen Community Care's interests. This includes: employment that uses confidential client information; employment that creates a prohibited dual relationship with a current client; or self-employment that competes directly with Evergreen Community Care's licensed programs.

### 5C.5 Use of Organizational Resources

Organizational equipment, premises, systems, time, client information, or professional relationships may not be used in support of any secondary employment or personal business under any circumstances. Violation of this provision is a serious disciplinary matter.



## 7A. SUCCESSION PLANNING AND LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT POLICY

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### 7A.1 Purpose

This policy ensures that Evergreen Community Care maintains operational continuity and organizational resilience by proactively identifying and developing internal leadership talent for key roles across the organization.

### 7A.2 Scope

Succession planning applies to all supervisory and management positions, including: Program Coordinator, Program Manager, Director of Human Resources, Director of Finance, and Executive Director. The process also identifies depth of coverage for critical front-line senior positions where extended vacancy would create service continuity risks.

### 7A.3 Annual Succession Review

The Executive Director, in consultation with the Board of Directors, conducts an annual succession review each October. The review addresses the following:

- Identification of positions at highest risk of vacancy: roles filled by a single individual, positions approaching retirement eligibility, or roles with a history of high turnover
- Assessment of current employees with leadership potential, including readiness timelines: ready now; ready within one to two years; potential within two to five years
- Identification of development gaps for each succession candidate and specific actions to address those gaps in the coming year
- Naming of a designated acting authority for the Executive Director role in the event of sudden planned or unplanned vacancy

### 7A.4 Development Support for Succession Candidates

Employees identified as succession candidates are offered targeted development opportunities which may include one or more of the following:

- Formal mentorship with the Executive Director or a senior organizational leader
- Acting or relief supervisory assignments during planned absences, with appropriate support and debrief
- Funded leadership or management training programs, including courses offered by the BC Social Services sector
- Representation at external sector committees, MCFD consultations, or professional working groups
- Cross-training in administrative, financial, or regulatory compliance functions

### 7A.5 Emergency Succession

A written emergency succession plan for the Executive Director role is maintained on file with the Board Chair at all times. The plan designates a named acting Executive Director and provides authority for interim financial approvals and MCFD contract commitments up to ninety (90) days.

### 7A.6 Confidentiality



Succession plans are confidential strategic documents available only to the Executive Director and Board. Employees may be informed that they have been identified as succession candidates as part of their development planning conversation, but broader disclosure of succession lists or timelines is at the Executive Director's discretion.



## 7B. ATTENDANCE MANAGEMENT POLICY

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### 7B.1 Purpose

Regular and reliable attendance is essential to the safety and continuity of residential care services. This policy establishes clear expectations for attendance and reporting, and a supportive, consistent management approach to absenteeism that respects employees' human rights obligations and duty-to-accommodate requirements.

### 7B.2 Attendance Expectations

- Employees are expected to report to work as scheduled and on time for every assigned shift
- Scheduled absences (approved leave) must be arranged in advance with the supervisor in accordance with the applicable leave policy
- Unplanned absences must be reported to the supervisor by telephone as early as possible and in any event no later than two (2) hours before the scheduled shift start time
- Reporting an unplanned absence by text message or by leaving a message with a coworker does not constitute proper notification unless the supervisor is unreachable by phone and an urgent voicemail has also been left
- Employees who are absent for three (3) or more consecutive days due to illness must notify Human Resources and their supervisor at least once every three days regarding the expected duration of the absence

### 7B.3 Patterns of Concern

The following attendance patterns may indicate a concern that warrants management attention and a supportive conversation:

- Three (3) or more unplanned absences within any rolling ninety (90) day period
- A pattern of absences consistently occurring adjacent to scheduled days off or statutory holidays
- Repeated failure to follow the notification procedure set out in Section 7B.2
- Extended absences that fall outside accrued sick leave entitlement without an approved leave in place

### 7B.4 Attendance Review Process

Where an attendance pattern of concern is identified, the supervisor initiates a private, supportive attendance review conversation with the employee. The review focuses first on understanding whether there is an underlying medical condition, disability, family status obligation, or workplace factor that the organization can support. Where the employee discloses a medical condition or disability, the Duty to Accommodate is triggered immediately and the Accommodation Policy (Section 9D) governs the process.

### 7B.5 Medical Documentation

Evergreen Community Care may request medical documentation confirming inability to work or fitness to return to work where: the absence exceeds three (3) consecutive calendar days; an attendance concern has been formally documented; or the employee is returning from an extended leave. The organization will not request diagnosis information; a physician's confirmation of functional limitations is sufficient for accommodation planning.



## 7B.6 Non-Culpable vs. Culpable Absenteeism

Attendance management distinguishes between non-culpable absenteeism (genuine illness, disability, protected ground) and culpable absenteeism (absence without reasonable cause, misuse of sick leave). Non-culpable absenteeism triggers the Accommodation Policy. Culpable absenteeism, where supported by evidence and investigation, may proceed through progressive discipline in accordance with Section 13.



## 9A. ANNUAL VACATION POLICY

### 9A.1 Legislative Basis

Annual vacation entitlement is governed by the BC Employment Standards Act (Part 7). This policy meets or exceeds ESA minimums and applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees. Casual and relief employees receive vacation pay as a percentage of gross wages per pay period in lieu of accrued time off, as required by the ESA.

### 9A.2 Vacation Entitlement Schedule

| Length of Continuous Service   | Annual Vacation Entitlement                                           |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Less than 1 year (ESA minimum) | 4% of gross wages, prorated from date of hire (approximately 2 weeks) |
| 1 to 4 years of service        | 10 working days (2 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |
| 5 to 9 years of service        | 15 working days (3 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |
| 10 to 14 years of service      | 20 working days (4 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |
| 15 or more years of service    | 25 working days (5 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |

### 9A.3 Vacation Scheduling

- Vacation requests must be submitted in writing to the supervisor a minimum of two (2) weeks in advance for requests of one week or less, and four (4) weeks in advance for requests of more than one week
- Requests are approved based on operational requirements, seniority, and the order in which requests are received where two or more employees request the same period
- Supervisors will not unreasonably deny vacation requests; operational need must be substantiated
- Employees are strongly encouraged to use their full annual vacation entitlement each year; wellness and restoration are organizational priorities in a high-demand residential care environment

### 9A.4 Vacation Carryover

Vacation may be carried forward by a maximum of five (5) days into the following entitlement year with supervisor approval. Unused vacation beyond this limit is paid out on the last pay date of the entitlement year. Carryover of more than five days requires Executive Director approval and a documented plan for the employee to take the deferred vacation within the first quarter of the following year.

### 9A.5 Vacation During Leaves of Absence

Vacation continues to accrue during periods of paid leave, including sick leave, approved EFAP leave, and paid statutory leaves. Vacation accrual during unpaid leaves of absence is subject to the specific provisions of the applicable leave type and the BC Employment Standards Act.

### 9A.6 Vacation Pay on Termination



Upon any separation from employment, all accrued and unused vacation pay is included in the employee's final pay, calculated at the applicable entitlement rate for their length of service. Vacation pay in lieu of notice is calculated separately under Section 18.



## 9B. SICK LEAVE POLICY

### 9B.1 Purpose and Legislative Basis

Evergreen Community Care provides paid sick leave to support employees in recovering from illness or injury without financial hardship. This policy meets or exceeds the BC Employment Standards Act requirements for paid sick leave (effective January 1, 2022: five paid sick days per year after ninety days of employment).

### 9B.2 Sick Leave Entitlement

| Employment Category              | Entitlement After 90 Days                        | Notes                    |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Full-Time Permanent              | 10 paid sick days per calendar year              | Prorated in year of hire |
| Part-Time Permanent              | Prorated based on FTE                            | Minimum 5 days per ESA   |
| Casual / Relief                  | 5 paid sick days per calendar year               | ESA minimum applies      |
| Fixed-Term                       | As specified in contract; minimum ESA provisions | ESA minimum applies      |
| During Probation (first 90 days) | Unpaid; ESA provisions apply after 90 days       | ESA minimum applies      |

### 9B.3 Notification Requirements

Employees must notify their supervisor of an unplanned sick day absence by telephone (not text message) as early as possible and no later than two (2) hours before the scheduled shift start time. Proper telephone notification is required for a sick day to be recorded as paid sick leave. Failure to notify using this procedure may result in the absence being treated as unpaid or subject to discipline.

### 9B.4 Medical Documentation

Evergreen Community Care may request written medical documentation where:

- The absence extends beyond three (3) consecutive calendar days
- A documented attendance concern has been identified and discussed with the employee
- The employee is returning from an extended medical leave or WorkSafeBC claim

The organization will not request diagnosis information. A note from a physician or nurse practitioner confirming that the employee was unable to work due to illness or injury, and confirming fitness to return to work, is sufficient.

### 9B.5 Interaction with WorkSafeBC Claims

Where an absence is due to a workplace injury or illness for which a WorkSafeBC claim has been filed and accepted, WorkSafeBC temporary total disability (TTD) benefits apply. Paid sick leave will not be used to top up WorkSafeBC benefits concurrently with an accepted claim unless specifically agreed in writing by both parties.

### 9B.6 Sick Leave Integrity

Sick leave is provided to support genuine illness and injury. Using sick leave for purposes other than personal illness or injury (for example, as additional unscheduled vacation days) is a



misuse of this benefit and constitutes a disciplinary matter that may result in progressive discipline up to and including termination of employment.



## 9C. BEREAVEMENT LEAVE POLICY

### 9C.1 Purpose

Evergreen Community Care recognizes that the loss of a loved one requires time to grieve, attend to family responsibilities, and participate in cultural and memorial practices. This policy provides paid bereavement leave as an expression of the organization's care for its employees as whole people.

### 9C.2 Paid Bereavement Leave Entitlement

| Relationship to Deceased                                                                   | Paid Leave Entitlement                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spouse or common-law partner                                                               | 5 working days                                                                       |
| Child, stepchild, or child of common-law partner                                           | 5 working days                                                                       |
| Parent or stepparent                                                                       | 5 working days                                                                       |
| Sibling or stepsibling                                                                     | 3 working days                                                                       |
| Grandparent or grandchild                                                                  | 3 working days                                                                       |
| Parent-in-law, sibling-in-law, or child-in-law                                             | 3 working days                                                                       |
| Aunt, uncle, niece, nephew                                                                 | 1 working day                                                                        |
| Other close relative or relationship of significance                                       | 1–3 days at supervisor discretion with HR approval                                   |
| Indigenous employees: loss of Elder, Knowledge Keeper, or community member of significance | Up to 3 working days, assessed with cultural sensitivity and in consultation with HR |

### 9C.3 Extended Leave for Travel

Where significant travel is required to attend a funeral, memorial service, or traditional ceremony, additional unpaid leave of up to two (2) working days may be approved by the supervisor. Employees needing additional time beyond these provisions may request additional unpaid leave or use accrued vacation time.

### 9C.4 Flexible Scheduling in Grief

Evergreen Community Care recognizes that grief does not follow a fixed timeline. Supervisors are encouraged to work with flexibility and compassion with employees managing bereavement, including approving temporary schedule modifications, adjusted duties, or referral to the EFAP counselling program where operationally possible.

### 9C.5 Notification

Employees should notify their supervisor of a bereavement absence as soon as practicable. Documentation (e.g., obituary, funeral program) may be requested in cases where the leave



duration or relationship is unclear, but will be handled with sensitivity and not requested unless necessary.



## 9D. ACCOMMODATION POLICY

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### 9D.1 Purpose and Legislative Basis

Evergreen Community Care has a legal and ethical duty under the BC Human Rights Code to accommodate employees with disabilities, family status obligations, religious observance requirements, and other protected characteristics, to the point of undue hardship. This policy establishes a clear, respectful, and timely process for workplace accommodation.

### 9D.2 Protected Grounds Covered

This policy applies to accommodation requests related to any ground protected under the BC Human Rights Code, including but not limited to:

- Physical or mental disability (including temporary medical conditions, chronic illness, and mental health diagnoses)
- Family status obligations (including primary caregiving responsibilities for children or dependent adults)
- Pregnancy and breastfeeding
- Religious or spiritual observance and practice
- Any other ground protected under the BC Human Rights Code

### 9D.3 How to Request Accommodation

Employees who require a workplace accommodation are encouraged to submit a written accommodation request to Human Resources or their supervisor as early as possible. The request should describe the functional need or limitation and the type of accommodation being sought. Employees are not required to disclose their specific diagnosis; functional limitations are sufficient.

### 9D.4 Accommodation Process

- Human Resources acknowledges the request within five (5) business days
- A collaborative meeting is arranged with the employee, their supervisor, and Human Resources to explore accommodation options
- The employee's health care provider may be asked to provide a functional limitations assessment (not a diagnosis) to support planning
- An Accommodation Plan is developed in writing, signed by the employee and Human Resources, and reviewed at agreed intervals
- The plan is updated as the employee's functional needs or circumstances change

### 9D.5 Duty to Participate

Accommodation is a collaborative process. The employee has a duty to participate in good faith, including: disclosing sufficient information to allow planning; cooperating with the assessment process; and considering reasonable accommodation options even if they are not the employee's preferred solution. Failure to participate in good faith may limit the organization's duty to accommodate.

### 9D.6 Undue Hardship

Accommodation is provided up to the point of undue hardship. Factors relevant to undue hardship include significant financial cost, serious health and safety risk to the employee or to



children and youth in care, and fundamental operational disruption. Undue hardship determinations require thorough analysis, consultation with Human Resources and legal counsel, and are documented in writing before any accommodation refusal is communicated.

### **9D.7 Confidentiality**

Accommodation information, including functional limitation assessments, is confidential. It is shared only with those who have a direct operational need to know in order to implement the accommodation plan. Medical or clinical information is not disclosed to supervisors or colleagues without the employee's explicit written consent.

## 9E. CRITICAL INCIDENT STRESS MANAGEMENT POLICY

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### 9E.1 Purpose

Residential care staff regularly encounter events involving serious harm, violence, medical emergencies, and the acute distress of children and youth with complex trauma histories. This policy ensures all staff have access to structured, timely support following critical incidents as a core component of Evergreen Community Care's commitment to staff wellness and secondary trauma prevention.

### 9E.2 Definition of Critical Incident

For the purpose of this policy, a critical incident is any event that has the potential to overwhelm an individual's normal coping mechanisms and produce significant acute stress responses.

Examples include:

- Serious physical assault on a staff member causing injury or significant distress
- Death or serious injury of a child, youth, or colleague at or connected to the workplace
- Suicide attempt or death by suicide of a child or youth currently or recently in care
- Major fire, vehicle accident, or natural disaster affecting the facility or staff while on duty
- Extended or severe behavioural crisis requiring physical intervention or emergency services
- Discovery of serious abuse, exploitation, or trafficking involving a youth in care
- Any event that a supervisor, Program Manager, or affected employee identifies as requiring structured debrief support

### 9E.3 Immediate Response: Defusing (Within 24 Hours)

Within twenty-four (24) hours of a critical incident, the Program Manager ensures that all directly involved staff are offered an informal defusing session. The defusing is a brief, structured conversation (30–60 minutes) that provides: immediate stabilization of acute stress reactions; practical information about normal stress responses; connection to further support; and temporary modified duties if indicated.

### 9E.4 Formal Debrief (48 to 72 Hours)

Within forty-eight (48) to seventy-two (72) hours of a significant critical incident, a structured Critical Incident Stress Debrief (CISD) is offered to all involved staff. The debrief is facilitated by the Program Manager for lower-severity incidents, or by an external mental health clinician with CISD training for major incidents. Attendance is strongly encouraged but is not mandatory.

### 9E.5 Ongoing Clinical Support

Following a major critical incident, staff may access trauma-focused counselling through the Employee and Family Assistance Program (EFAP) at no cost to the employee. The organization may also arrange, at its own expense, additional clinical sessions beyond the standard EFAP allocation where the incident is assessed as having major organizational impact.

### 9E.6 Return to High-Demand Duties

Staff affected by a critical incident must not be returned to high-demand or high-acuity shifts without supervisor confirmation that they are ready and able to do so safely. A brief wellness check-in with the supervisor or Program Manager is conducted before an affected employee returns to full duties. Supervisors who are themselves directly affected by a critical incident must



delegate supervisory responsibilities to a qualified designate before returning to decision-making duties.



## 10A. EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE PROGRAM (EAP) POLICY

### 10A.1 Program Overview

Evergreen Community Care provides access to a confidential Employee and Family Assistance Program (EFAP) for all employees and their immediate family members. Access to the EFAP is available from the first day of employment, regardless of employment category, probationary status, or hours worked.

### 10A.2 Services Available Through the EFAP

| Service                | Description                                                                                                  |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Short-term counselling | Individual, couples, and family counselling (typically 6–8 sessions per presenting concern per benefit year) |
| Mental health support  | Anxiety, depression, grief, trauma, burnout, and relationship difficulties                                   |
| Crisis support         | Available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, by telephone                                                        |
| Legal consultation     | One initial session per legal matter                                                                         |
| Financial counselling  | Budgeting, debt management, and financial planning                                                           |
| Nutrition and wellness | Registered dietitian consultations and wellness coaching                                                     |
| Work-life resources    | Childcare and elder care referrals, community support navigation                                             |

### 10A.3 Confidentiality Guarantee

All EFAP services are strictly confidential. Evergreen Community Care does not receive any information about which employees access the program, the frequency of use, or the nature of the issues being addressed. The only exception to confidentiality is where the EFAP provider is legally required to disclose information due to imminent risk of serious harm to the employee or another person. Use of the EFAP has no bearing on employment status, performance evaluations, or disciplinary decisions.

### 10A.4 How to Access the EFAP

EFAP contact information is provided to all employees at orientation, posted in staff areas at all facilities, and included in the onboarding package. Employees may self-refer at any time by calling the EFAP directly. Neither supervisor approval nor HR notification is required to access the program. The EFAP contact number is also available through Human Resources at any time.

### 10A.5 Supervisory Referrals

Supervisors may bring information about the EFAP to an employee's attention and encourage its use when they observe signs of stress, difficulty, or declining wellbeing. A supervisory referral is informational and supportive only; supervisors may not mandate participation in EFAP services as a condition of employment. A formal fitness-for-duty assessment, where clinically warranted, is a separate process governed by Human Resources and medical professionals.

### 10A.6 EFAP During Critical Incidents



Following major critical incidents, Human Resources or the Program Manager will actively connect affected staff with EFAP services as part of the Critical Incident Stress Management response (Section 9E). In such cases, the organization may arrange a group or individual EFAP session at its expense in addition to standard EFAP access.

## 10B. WORKPLACE VIOLENCE PREVENTION PROGRAM

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### 10B.1 Purpose and Regulatory Basis

This section documents Evergreen Community Care's written Workplace Violence Prevention Program as required under Sections 4.27 through 4.31 of the BC Occupational Health and Safety Regulation. It supplements the general provisions contained in Section 15.4 of this binder and provides the operational detail required by WorkSafeBC.

### 10B.2 Annual Violence Risk Assessment

The Program Manager, in consultation with the Joint Health and Safety Committee, conducts a written workplace violence risk assessment at each facility annually and whenever significant changes in the client population, staffing model, or physical environment occur. The assessment considers:

- Nature of the client population served: trauma history, known behavioural risk factors, mental health diagnoses, history of aggression
- Physical layout of each facility: sightlines, isolation risks, access control, proximity to emergency exits
- Staffing levels and supervision patterns at each time of day and day of week
- History of violent incidents at the facility over the preceding twelve (12) months
- Identified high-risk situations: transitions, mealtimes, bedtime routines, community outings

### 10B.3 Violence Prevention Measures

Based on the risk assessment findings, the following prevention controls are implemented as applicable at each facility:

- Individual Behaviour Support Plans for youth with a documented history of physical aggression, reviewed and updated by the Program Manager at each ISP review period
- Staff-to-youth ratios maintained at levels that allow safe de-escalation and intervention without staff isolation
- Check-in protocols for staff working late-night or isolated areas of the facility
- Communication devices (phone, walkie-talkie, or personal alarm) available to all on-duty staff at all times
- Physical facility design reviewed annually by the Program Manager to reduce blind spots and isolated areas
- Mandatory Non-Violent Crisis Intervention training for all direct-care staff

### 10B.4 Reporting and Post-Incident Requirements

All violent incidents, including threats, intimidation, property damage with an implicit threat, and physical assaults (regardless of injury level), are reported immediately to the supervisor and documented on the Incident Report form within twenty-four (24) hours. The JHSC reviews all violence-related incident reports at monthly meetings and recommends corrective actions. Post-incident support follows Section 9E (Critical Incident Stress Management).

### 10B.5 Worker Rights

No worker will be required to work in conditions where they face an immediate and unmitigated risk of physical violence. Workers may exercise the Right to Refuse Unsafe Work under Section



15.6 in response to a specific and immediate violence threat, without fear of reprisal. Supervisors must take all violence concerns raised by staff seriously and document the response.



## 10C. SOCIAL MEDIA AND ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS POLICY

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### 10C.1 Purpose

This policy establishes standards for employee use of social media and electronic communications to protect the privacy and dignity of children and youth in care, preserve organizational reputation, and ensure compliance with the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FOIPPA), the Personal Information Protection Act (PIPA), and the Child, Family and Community Service Act.

### 10C.2 Scope

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and volunteers of Evergreen Community Care and covers all social media platforms, messaging applications, and online forums, whether accessed on organizational devices, personal devices, during work hours, or during personal time, where the content relates to the organization, its programs, or the children and youth it serves.

### 10C.3 Absolute Prohibitions

The following conduct is strictly prohibited and constitutes grounds for immediate suspension and may result in termination of employment without notice:

- Posting, sharing, transmitting, or storing any photograph, video, or identifying information relating to a child or youth in care on any platform or device
- Disclosing the name, location, physical description, family relationships, or placement history of any child or youth in care
- Sharing information about incidents, behavioural events, or circumstances involving children or youth, even without using names or other obvious identifiers
- Connecting with, accepting friend or follower requests from, or initiating social media contact with current or former clients of Evergreen Community Care
- Posting content that brings Evergreen Community Care, MCFD, or the residential care sector into disrepute

### 10C.4 Professional Conduct Online

Employees are expected to conduct themselves professionally in all online environments. Content that would violate the Code of Conduct or the Anti-Harassment Policy in person also violates those policies when posted online. Employees are reminded that content described as private, restricted, or posted to a closed group may still reach unintended audiences, including clients, families, MCFD licensing staff, and the general public.

### 10C.5 Personal Device Use During Shifts

Personal mobile devices are not to be used for social media browsing, personal messaging, or any non-work-related communication during active shifts when staff are responsible for the supervision of children or youth. Brief personal telephone calls during scheduled breaks are permitted. Photographing children or youth on personal devices is prohibited at all times, including when staff are on-site during off-duty hours.

### 10C.6 Organizational Social Media

Only staff expressly designated and authorized by the Executive Director may post content on behalf of Evergreen Community Care on official organizational social media accounts or



websites. Employees may not represent themselves as speaking on behalf of the organization in any public online forum without prior written authorization from the Executive Director.

## 10D. RESPECTFUL WORKPLACE POLICY

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### 10D.1 Commitment

Evergreen Community Care is committed to maintaining a workplace free from bullying, harassment, intimidation, and all forms of disrespectful conduct. This commitment reflects both our legal obligations under the BC Workers Compensation Act and WorkSafeBC Policies and our values as an organization dedicated to the dignity of every person, including our own employees.

### 10D.2 Definition of Workplace Bullying and Harassment

Consistent with WorkSafeBC Policy D3-115-2, workplace bullying and harassment means any conduct by a person toward a worker in the workplace that the person knew or reasonably ought to have known would cause the worker to be humiliated or intimidated, and includes repeated conduct or a single serious act. Examples include:

- Repeated hurtful, demeaning, or abusive remarks or written communications
- Social or professional exclusion without legitimate organizational justification
- Intimidating behaviour, threats, or conduct that creates a climate of fear
- Deliberately overloading an employee with unreasonable workloads without support, or conversely removing meaningful work without explanation
- Spreading false information, rumours, or malicious gossip about a colleague
- Public humiliation or demeaning criticism of an employee in front of their team or clients

### 10D.3 What Does Not Constitute Bullying and Harassment

Reasonable management actions carried out appropriately and in good faith are not bullying and harassment. These include: providing work direction and performance feedback; managing attendance or productivity concerns; issuing appropriate disciplinary measures in response to conduct or performance issues; and making operational decisions about staffing, scheduling, or program assignments.

### 10D.4 Reporting and Investigation

Employees who experience or witness workplace bullying or harassment are encouraged to report the behaviour to their supervisor, the Director of Human Resources, or the Executive Director. Where the alleged harasser is the employee's supervisor, the report is made directly to Human Resources or the Executive Director. All complaints are investigated promptly, fairly, impartially, and with appropriate confidentiality. Both the complainant and the respondent are entitled to be informed of the allegations, have an opportunity to respond, and receive a written outcome.

### 10D.5 Prohibition on Retaliation

No employee will face retaliation, adverse employment action, or negative treatment for making a good-faith complaint of bullying or harassment, or for participating as a witness in an investigation. Retaliation against a complainant or witness is itself a serious disciplinary offence that may result in termination of employment. Employees who believe they are experiencing retaliation should report this immediately to Human Resources.

### 10D.6 Employer Obligations



Evergreen Community Care fulfils its employer obligations under WorkSafeBC Policy D3-115-2 by: maintaining this written policy; providing annual training to all staff and supervisors on recognizing and preventing workplace bullying and harassment; investigating all formal complaints; taking corrective action where harassment is substantiated; and annually reviewing the effectiveness of prevention measures.



## 10E. WORKING ALONE OR IN ISOLATION POLICY

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### 10E.1 Regulatory Basis

This policy fulfils Evergreen Community Care's obligations under Sections 4.21 through 4.24 of the BC Occupational Health and Safety Regulation regarding workers who work alone or in isolation in circumstances where assistance may not be readily available in the event of an injury, illness, or emergency.

### 10E.2 Identification of Working-Alone Situations

The Program Manager maintains a current register of roles and work circumstances within Evergreen Community Care that involve working alone or in isolation. The register is reviewed and updated annually and whenever significant changes occur in staffing patterns, facility use, or the client population. Working-alone situations may include: single-staff overnight shifts; staff working alone in an office or administrative area after hours; and staff conducting activities in areas of the facility with limited sightlines or communication access.

### 10E.3 Risk Assessment

For each identified working-alone situation, a risk assessment is conducted by the Program Manager in consultation with the JHSC. The assessment considers: the nature of the tasks performed while alone; the vulnerability of the client population present; communication options available in the area; history of incidents in the location; and estimated emergency response time from the nearest available assistance.

### 10E.4 Control Measures

Based on the risk assessment outcome, one or more of the following control measures is implemented for each working-alone situation:

- Scheduled check-in system: the worker contacts a designated person (supervisor, on-call manager, or after-hours contact) at defined intervals not to exceed two (2) hours; if a check-in is missed, the designate follows the escalating emergency response protocol immediately
- Personal communication device: a fully charged phone, two-way radio, or personal alarm device is provided to the worker and confirmed functional at the beginning of each shift
- Modified scheduling: where risk assessment indicates that a specific task cannot be performed safely alone, minimum two-staff coverage is required
- Environmental controls: physical layout modifications (improved lighting, removal of blind spots) to reduce isolation risk

### 10E.5 Emergency Response Protocol

A written emergency response protocol is maintained at each facility. The protocol specifies: the designated check-in contact by shift and by day; the escalation steps when a check-in is missed (attempt phone contact; contact second designate; contact 911; notify Program Manager); and the chain of notification following any emergency response. Protocols are reviewed annually and posted at each facility.

### 10E.6 Documentation and JHSC Review



Working-alone check-in records are maintained at each facility using the designated log sheet. The JHSC reviews these records during monthly inspections and reports any compliance gaps to the Program Manager. Systematic non-compliance with check-in procedures is treated as a workplace safety matter and addressed through the OHS program.



## 10F. IMPAIRMENT AND SUBSTANCE USE POLICY

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### 10F.1 Purpose

The safety of children and youth in Evergreen Community Care's residential programs requires that all employees are fully fit for duty throughout every shift. This policy addresses impairment from alcohol, cannabis, illicit substances, and prescription or over-the-counter medication, and does so in a manner consistent with the BC Human Rights Code, the Workers Compensation Act, and contemporary harm-reduction principles.

### 10F.2 Fitness for Duty Standard

All employees are required to report to and remain fit for duty throughout their entire scheduled shift. An employee is considered impaired when their ability to safely perform assigned duties is affected by any substance, including alcohol, cannabis, controlled substances, or prescription and over-the-counter medication that produce sedation, impaired reaction time, or reduced cognitive function.

### 10F.3 Prohibited Conduct

- Reporting for duty while impaired by any substance, regardless of whether impairment was caused by recreational or prescribed medication use
- Consuming alcohol within eight (8) hours of the start of a scheduled shift, or twelve (12) hours for any shift involving the operation of a vehicle
- Consuming cannabis within twelve (12) hours of the start of any scheduled shift
- Consuming controlled substances not prescribed by a licensed health care provider at any time before or during a shift
- Being in possession of illicit substances on organizational property or in organizational vehicles, or while transporting clients
- Consuming alcohol, cannabis, or any controlled substance on organizational property during a shift or during any work-related travel

### 10F.4 Prescription and Over-the-Counter Medication

Employees taking prescription or over-the-counter medication that may impair alertness, reaction time, motor coordination, or judgment are required to inform their supervisor prior to the start of their shift, so that modified duties or other accommodations can be considered. Employees are not required to disclose the specific medication; confirmation from a pharmacist or prescriber that the medication may impair work performance is sufficient. Supervisors must treat this disclosure with full confidentiality.

### 10F.5 Reasonable Grounds Assessment

Where a supervisor has reasonable grounds to believe that an employee may be impaired while on duty (based on observable indicators: slurred speech, unsteady gait, impaired judgment, unusual odour, or self-disclosure), the supervisor will remove the employee from direct client contact immediately and conduct a private, respectful conversation. The employee may be relieved of duty for the remainder of the shift. A formal investigation follows, conducted by Human Resources in accordance with the Progressive Discipline Policy (Section 13).

### 10F.6 Duty to Accommodate Substance Dependency



Substance use disorder and addiction are recognized as disabilities under the BC Human Rights Code. Where an employee voluntarily discloses a dependency or addiction, Evergreen Community Care fulfils its duty to accommodate to the point of undue hardship. Accommodation may include: support in accessing the EFAP and external addiction treatment; medical leave to attend a treatment program; and a structured graduated return-to-work plan developed jointly with HR, the employee, and the treating health care provider. An employee who voluntarily discloses a substance dependency and actively engages in treatment will not be subject to progressive discipline for the underlying disclosure alone.



## 3A. REFERENCE CHECK POLICY

### 3A.1 Purpose

This policy establishes consistent, equitable, and legally compliant procedures for verifying candidate references as part of Evergreen Community Care's recruitment process for all positions.

### 3A.2 Policy Statement

Reference checks are mandatory before any offer of employment is finalized. No candidate may commence employment until at least two professional references have been verified and documented.

### 3A.3 Minimum Reference Requirements

| Requirement                  | Standard                                                                   |
|------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Minimum number of references | Two (2) professional references                                            |
| Required type                | At least one (1) must be a direct supervisor or manager in a relevant role |
| Recency                      | At least one reference from employment within the past five (5) years      |
| Character references         | Not accepted in lieu of professional; may supplement as a third reference  |
| Candidate consent            | Written consent obtained before any reference is contacted                 |

### 3A.4 Reference Check Process

- The recruiting supervisor or Human Resources contacts references by telephone using a standardized reference questionnaire
- Questions focus on job-related competencies: reliability, judgment, professional boundaries, trauma-informed practice, teamwork, and suitability for working with vulnerable youth
- Questions about age, family status, religion, disability, or any other ground protected under the BC Human Rights Code are strictly prohibited
- Reference check notes are documented in writing and retained as part of the candidate's recruitment file
- Where a reference raises significant concerns, Human Resources and the hiring supervisor review the information jointly before a final decision is made

### 3A.5 Record Retention

Reference check records are retained in the employee's personnel file for the duration of employment and for seven (7) years following separation, consistent with CRA and employment records requirements.



## **3B. OFFER OF EMPLOYMENT AND EMPLOYMENT CONTRACT POLICY**

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### **3B.1 Purpose**

This policy ensures all employment offers made by Evergreen Community Care are clear, complete, legally compliant, and consistently administered across all programs and positions.

### **3B.2 Written Offer Requirement**

All offers of employment are made in writing. A verbal offer may be extended as a courtesy, but a written offer letter must be provided within two (2) business days and signed by the candidate before employment commences. No candidate may begin work without a signed offer letter on file.

### **3B.3 Required Content of the Offer Letter**

- Position title, classification level, and reporting relationship
- Employment category (full-time, part-time, casual/relief, fixed-term) and expected hours of work
- Start date and primary work location or program assignment
- Compensation: hourly rate or annual salary, applicable shift premiums, and pay period
- Probationary period terms and duration (six months for all new permanent positions)
- Conditions of the offer: clear Criminal Record Check, credential verification, and right to work in Canada
- Reference to the HR Policy Binder and Residential Care Policy Manual as governing employment terms
- Benefit eligibility category and anticipated effective date

### **3B.4 Conditional Offers**

All offers for positions involving contact with children or youth are conditional upon receipt of a clear Vulnerable Sector Criminal Record Check. No candidate may begin working with children or youth, even on a supervised basis, until the clear CRC is confirmed on file with Human Resources.

### **3B.5 Fixed-Term Contracts**

Fixed-term contracts must specify start and end dates, the reason for the fixed term, compensation terms, and the terms of any renewal. Fixed-term employees do not have a right of renewal unless explicitly stated in writing. Fixed-term employees whose contract is renewed more than twice in the same role may trigger employment standards review for continuous employment status.

### **3B.6 Signing Authority**

Offer letters and employment contracts are signed by the Director of Human Resources or the Executive Director. Program Managers and supervisors do not have authority to make verbal or written employment commitments outside this formal process. Any unauthorized verbal offer is not binding on the organization.



## 3C. CONTRACTOR AND CONSULTANT ENGAGEMENT POLICY

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### 3C.1 Purpose

This policy governs the engagement of independent contractors, consultants, and agency-placed workers to ensure legal compliance with CRA worker classification rules, BC employment standards, and Evergreen Community Care's child safety obligations.

### 3C.2 Scope

This policy applies to all individuals engaged to perform work for Evergreen Community Care who are not employees, including independent contractors, consulting firms, agency-placed or contract staff, practicum students supervised by external institutions, and service vendors with regular site access.

### 3C.3 Worker Classification

Evergreen Community Care complies with CRA and Employment Standards Act guidelines on the distinction between employees and contractors. Where the nature of an engagement reflects an employment relationship (regular direction and control, organizational equipment, economic dependence), the individual must be engaged as an employee. Human Resources and Finance review all contractor arrangements annually to confirm correct classification and avoid misclassification liability.

### 3C.4 Child Safety Requirements

Any contractor, consultant, or agency-placed worker who will have unsupervised access to children or youth must, prior to commencing work on-site:

- Provide a clear Vulnerable Sector Criminal Record Check dated within twelve (12) months
- Sign Evergreen Community Care's Confidentiality Agreement (Appendix B)
- Complete the Child Abuse Recognition and Duty to Report orientation (minimum 30 minutes)
- Acknowledge the organization's Restrictive Practices Policy and mandatory reporting obligations in writing

### 3C.5 Written Service Agreements

All contractor and consultant engagements exceeding \$2,500 or lasting longer than thirty (30) days require a written service agreement. Agreements must specify: scope of work, deliverables, timeline, fee structure, confidentiality obligations, intellectual property ownership, and termination provisions. Agreements are approved by the Executive Director before work commences.

### 3C.6 Approval and Signing Authority

Contractor agreements are signed by the Executive Director. Program Managers may not commit the organization to contractor or consultant services without prior Executive Director approval and a signed service agreement. Unauthorized verbal engagements are not binding on the organization.



## 5A. OVERTIME AND LIEU TIME POLICY

### 5A.1 Purpose

This policy establishes Evergreen Community Care's practices for managing overtime hours and time off in lieu (lieu time) in a manner that is fair, compliant with the BC Employment Standards Act, and supportive of employee health and wellness.

### 5A.2 Overtime Entitlement

Overtime entitlement is calculated in accordance with the BC Employment Standards Act, as follows:

| Overtime Situation                                        | Rate Payable                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
| Hours worked beyond 8 hours in a day (up to 12 hours/day) | 1.5 times regular wage                               |
| Hours worked beyond 12 hours in a single day              | 2.0 times regular wage                               |
| Hours worked beyond 40 hours in a work week               | 1.5 times regular wage                               |
| Statutory holiday work                                    | Regular pay plus applicable stat holiday pay per ESA |

### 5A.3 Pre-Approval Requirement

Overtime must be pre-approved in writing (or confirmed in writing following verbal approval) by the employee's supervisor before overtime hours are worked, except in emergency operational circumstances where children or youth would otherwise be left without adequate supervision. In such cases, the supervisor must be notified of the emergency overtime within twenty-four (24) hours.

### 5A.4 Banking Overtime as Lieu Time

By written agreement between the employee and the organization, overtime may be banked as paid time off in lieu at the applicable overtime rate (e.g., 1.5 hours of time off per each hour of overtime worked at the time-and-a-half rate). The following conditions apply to lieu time banks:

- Lieu time must be taken within three (3) months of being earned, or the equivalent overtime pay is issued on the next regular pay statement
- Scheduling of lieu time is by mutual agreement between the employee and supervisor, subject to operational requirements
- Outstanding lieu time balances are shown on each employee pay statement
- Any unused lieu time balance is paid out at the applicable overtime rate upon separation from employment

### 5A.5 Casual and Relief Employees

Casual and relief employees receive overtime pay on the same daily and weekly basis as permanent employees. Because casual employees have no guaranteed minimum hours, the 40-hour weekly threshold is assessed based on hours actually worked in the calendar week, not against a scheduled minimum.



## 5A.6 Scheduling and Rest Periods

Schedules are designed to provide employees with a minimum of eight (8) consecutive hours free from work between shifts. Supervisors must not create schedules that deny employees adequate rest between shifts on a regular basis, as this constitutes a WorkSafeBC fatigue-related hazard and increases the risk of errors in care delivery.



## 5B. MILEAGE AND VEHICLE USE POLICY

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### 5B.1 Purpose

This policy governs the safe, accountable, and legally compliant use of organizational vehicles and the reimbursement of employees who use personal vehicles for authorized work purposes on behalf of Evergreen Community Care.

### 5B.2 Use of Organizational Vehicles

- Organizational vehicles are to be used for work-related purposes only; personal use is not permitted without written prior authorization from the Executive Director
- All drivers of organizational vehicles must hold a valid BC Class 5 or higher driver's licence and must submit an annual driver's abstract to Human Resources each January
- Vehicles must not be operated by any person who has consumed alcohol within the preceding eight (8) hours, or cannabis or controlled substances within the preceding twelve (12) hours
- No vehicle may be operated while the driver is taking prescription or over-the-counter medication that warns against operating machinery or motor vehicles
- All vehicle occupants must wear seatbelts at all times; the driver is responsible for confirming all passengers are belted before moving the vehicle
- Mobile phones must not be held or handled while driving; hands-free devices may be used only where the call is essential to the operation
- Any accident, collision, or vehicle damage involving an organizational vehicle must be reported to the supervisor immediately and documented on the Vehicle Incident Report form within twenty-four (24) hours

### 5B.3 Transporting Children and Youth

When transporting children or youth in organizational or authorized personal vehicles, the following additional requirements apply in all circumstances:

- Age and weight-appropriate child restraints (car seats, booster seats) must be used per BC Motor Vehicle Act requirements
- A minimum of one staff member in addition to the driver must be present when transporting more than two children or youth, or when any child presents elevated behavioural or safety needs identified in their care plan
- A transport log must be completed for every trip involving children or youth, recording: date, origin, destination, purpose, driver name, names of youth passengers, and departure and return times
- Youth must never be left unattended in a vehicle

### 5B.4 Personal Vehicle Use and Mileage Reimbursement

Employees who are authorized in advance to use a personal vehicle for work-related travel are reimbursed at the current CRA prescribed mileage rate, updated annually each January. To claim mileage reimbursement:

- Supervisor pre-approval must be obtained before using a personal vehicle for work travel



- The employee must maintain personal automobile insurance with a minimum of \$2,000,000 third-party liability coverage; the employee is responsible for confirming their policy's business use provisions with their insurer
- A completed mileage log must accompany each expense reimbursement claim, recording: date, origin, destination, business purpose, and kilometres driven
- Travel between an employee's home and their primary regular workplace is commuting and is not eligible for mileage reimbursement



## 5C. SECONDARY EMPLOYMENT POLICY

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### 5C.1 Purpose

Evergreen Community Care respects employees' right to hold secondary employment or self-employment outside of their role with the organization. This policy ensures that secondary employment does not create conflicts of interest, compromise the confidentiality of children or youth in care, or impair an employee's ability to fulfil their primary responsibilities safely.

### 5C.2 Disclosure Requirement

Employees must disclose secondary or self-employment to Human Resources in writing where it meets any of the following conditions:

- Employment or self-employment with another residential care, foster care, child welfare, or social services organization in British Columbia
- Any role that involves the care, support, supervision, or professional relationship with current Evergreen Community Care clients or their immediate family members
- Any role involving a former client within two years of their last date of service with Evergreen Community Care
- Cumulative work hours across all employment that may cause the employee to work more than sixty (60) hours in any given work week, potentially affecting fitness for duty
- Any business or contractual relationship with vendors, contractors, or services providers used by Evergreen Community Care

### 5C.3 Review and Approval

Human Resources and the Program Manager review all disclosures within ten (10) business days and confirm in writing whether a conflict exists. Where no conflict is identified, no further action is required beyond the disclosure being filed. Where a potential conflict is identified, the employee is required to resolve it prior to returning to independent shifts.

### 5C.4 Prohibited Secondary Employment

Employees may not hold secondary employment that directly conflicts with Evergreen Community Care's interests. This includes: employment that uses confidential client information; employment that creates a prohibited dual relationship with a current client; or self-employment that competes directly with Evergreen Community Care's licensed programs.

### 5C.5 Use of Organizational Resources

Organizational equipment, premises, systems, time, client information, or professional relationships may not be used in support of any secondary employment or personal business under any circumstances. Violation of this provision is a serious disciplinary matter.



## 7A. SUCCESSION PLANNING AND LEADERSHIP DEVELOPMENT POLICY

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### 7A.1 Purpose

This policy ensures that Evergreen Community Care maintains operational continuity and organizational resilience by proactively identifying and developing internal leadership talent for key roles across the organization.

### 7A.2 Scope

Succession planning applies to all supervisory and management positions, including: Program Coordinator, Program Manager, Director of Human Resources, Director of Finance, and Executive Director. The process also identifies depth of coverage for critical front-line senior positions where extended vacancy would create service continuity risks.

### 7A.3 Annual Succession Review

The Executive Director, in consultation with the Board of Directors, conducts an annual succession review each October. The review addresses the following:

- Identification of positions at highest risk of vacancy: roles filled by a single individual, positions approaching retirement eligibility, or roles with a history of high turnover
- Assessment of current employees with leadership potential, including readiness timelines: ready now; ready within one to two years; potential within two to five years
- Identification of development gaps for each succession candidate and specific actions to address those gaps in the coming year
- Naming of a designated acting authority for the Executive Director role in the event of sudden planned or unplanned vacancy

### 7A.4 Development Support for Succession Candidates

Employees identified as succession candidates are offered targeted development opportunities which may include one or more of the following:

- Formal mentorship with the Executive Director or a senior organizational leader
- Acting or relief supervisory assignments during planned absences, with appropriate support and debrief
- Funded leadership or management training programs, including courses offered by the BC Social Services sector
- Representation at external sector committees, MCFD consultations, or professional working groups
- Cross-training in administrative, financial, or regulatory compliance functions

### 7A.5 Emergency Succession

A written emergency succession plan for the Executive Director role is maintained on file with the Board Chair at all times. The plan designates a named acting Executive Director and provides authority for interim financial approvals and MCFD contract commitments up to ninety (90) days.

### 7A.6 Confidentiality



Succession plans are confidential strategic documents available only to the Executive Director and Board. Employees may be informed that they have been identified as succession candidates as part of their development planning conversation, but broader disclosure of succession lists or timelines is at the Executive Director's discretion.



## 7B. ATTENDANCE MANAGEMENT POLICY

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### 7B.1 Purpose

Regular and reliable attendance is essential to the safety and continuity of residential care services. This policy establishes clear expectations for attendance and reporting, and a supportive, consistent management approach to absenteeism that respects employees' human rights obligations and duty-to-accommodate requirements.

### 7B.2 Attendance Expectations

- Employees are expected to report to work as scheduled and on time for every assigned shift
- Scheduled absences (approved leave) must be arranged in advance with the supervisor in accordance with the applicable leave policy
- Unplanned absences must be reported to the supervisor by telephone as early as possible and in any event no later than two (2) hours before the scheduled shift start time
- Reporting an unplanned absence by text message or by leaving a message with a coworker does not constitute proper notification unless the supervisor is unreachable by phone and an urgent voicemail has also been left
- Employees who are absent for three (3) or more consecutive days due to illness must notify Human Resources and their supervisor at least once every three days regarding the expected duration of the absence

### 7B.3 Patterns of Concern

The following attendance patterns may indicate a concern that warrants management attention and a supportive conversation:

- Three (3) or more unplanned absences within any rolling ninety (90) day period
- A pattern of absences consistently occurring adjacent to scheduled days off or statutory holidays
- Repeated failure to follow the notification procedure set out in Section 7B.2
- Extended absences that fall outside accrued sick leave entitlement without an approved leave in place

### 7B.4 Attendance Review Process

Where an attendance pattern of concern is identified, the supervisor initiates a private, supportive attendance review conversation with the employee. The review focuses first on understanding whether there is an underlying medical condition, disability, family status obligation, or workplace factor that the organization can support. Where the employee discloses a medical condition or disability, the Duty to Accommodate is triggered immediately and the Accommodation Policy (Section 9D) governs the process.

### 7B.5 Medical Documentation

Evergreen Community Care may request medical documentation confirming inability to work or fitness to return to work where: the absence exceeds three (3) consecutive calendar days; an attendance concern has been formally documented; or the employee is returning from an extended leave. The organization will not request diagnosis information; a physician's confirmation of functional limitations is sufficient for accommodation planning.



## **7B.6 Non-Culpable vs. Culpable Absenteeism**

Attendance management distinguishes between non-culpable absenteeism (genuine illness, disability, protected ground) and culpable absenteeism (absence without reasonable cause, misuse of sick leave). Non-culpable absenteeism triggers the Accommodation Policy. Culpable absenteeism, where supported by evidence and investigation, may proceed through progressive discipline in accordance with Section 13.



## 9A. ANNUAL VACATION POLICY

### 9A.1 Legislative Basis

Annual vacation entitlement is governed by the BC Employment Standards Act (Part 7). This policy meets or exceeds ESA minimums and applies to all permanent and fixed-term employees. Casual and relief employees receive vacation pay as a percentage of gross wages per pay period in lieu of accrued time off, as required by the ESA.

### 9A.2 Vacation Entitlement Schedule

| Length of Continuous Service   | Annual Vacation Entitlement                                           |
|--------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Less than 1 year (ESA minimum) | 4% of gross wages, prorated from date of hire (approximately 2 weeks) |
| 1 to 4 years of service        | 10 working days (2 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |
| 5 to 9 years of service        | 15 working days (3 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |
| 10 to 14 years of service      | 20 working days (4 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |
| 15 or more years of service    | 25 working days (5 weeks) paid vacation per entitlement year          |

### 9A.3 Vacation Scheduling

- Vacation requests must be submitted in writing to the supervisor a minimum of two (2) weeks in advance for requests of one week or less, and four (4) weeks in advance for requests of more than one week
- Requests are approved based on operational requirements, seniority, and the order in which requests are received where two or more employees request the same period
- Supervisors will not unreasonably deny vacation requests; operational need must be substantiated
- Employees are strongly encouraged to use their full annual vacation entitlement each year; wellness and restoration are organizational priorities in a high-demand residential care environment

### 9A.4 Vacation Carryover

Vacation may be carried forward by a maximum of five (5) days into the following entitlement year with supervisor approval. Unused vacation beyond this limit is paid out on the last pay date of the entitlement year. Carryover of more than five days requires Executive Director approval and a documented plan for the employee to take the deferred vacation within the first quarter of the following year.

### 9A.5 Vacation During Leaves of Absence

Vacation continues to accrue during periods of paid leave, including sick leave, approved EFAP leave, and paid statutory leaves. Vacation accrual during unpaid leaves of absence is subject to the specific provisions of the applicable leave type and the BC Employment Standards Act.

### 9A.6 Vacation Pay on Termination



Upon any separation from employment, all accrued and unused vacation pay is included in the employee's final pay, calculated at the applicable entitlement rate for their length of service. Vacation pay in lieu of notice is calculated separately under Section 18.



## 9B. SICK LEAVE POLICY

### 9B.1 Purpose and Legislative Basis

Evergreen Community Care provides paid sick leave to support employees in recovering from illness or injury without financial hardship. This policy meets or exceeds the BC Employment Standards Act requirements for paid sick leave (effective January 1, 2022: five paid sick days per year after ninety days of employment).

### 9B.2 Sick Leave Entitlement

| Employment Category              | Entitlement After 90 Days                        | Notes                    |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Full-Time Permanent              | 10 paid sick days per calendar year              | Prorated in year of hire |
| Part-Time Permanent              | Prorated based on FTE                            | Minimum 5 days per ESA   |
| Casual / Relief                  | 5 paid sick days per calendar year               | ESA minimum applies      |
| Fixed-Term                       | As specified in contract; minimum ESA provisions | ESA minimum applies      |
| During Probation (first 90 days) | Unpaid; ESA provisions apply after 90 days       | ESA minimum applies      |

### 9B.3 Notification Requirements

Employees must notify their supervisor of an unplanned sick day absence by telephone (not text message) as early as possible and no later than two (2) hours before the scheduled shift start time. Proper telephone notification is required for a sick day to be recorded as paid sick leave. Failure to notify using this procedure may result in the absence being treated as unpaid or subject to discipline.

### 9B.4 Medical Documentation

Evergreen Community Care may request written medical documentation where:

- The absence extends beyond three (3) consecutive calendar days
- A documented attendance concern has been identified and discussed with the employee
- The employee is returning from an extended medical leave or WorkSafeBC claim

The organization will not request diagnosis information. A note from a physician or nurse practitioner confirming that the employee was unable to work due to illness or injury, and confirming fitness to return to work, is sufficient.

### 9B.5 Interaction with WorkSafeBC Claims

Where an absence is due to a workplace injury or illness for which a WorkSafeBC claim has been filed and accepted, WorkSafeBC temporary total disability (TTD) benefits apply. Paid sick leave will not be used to top up WorkSafeBC benefits concurrently with an accepted claim unless specifically agreed in writing by both parties.

### 9B.6 Sick Leave Integrity

Sick leave is provided to support genuine illness and injury. Using sick leave for purposes other than personal illness or injury (for example, as additional unscheduled vacation days) is a



misuse of this benefit and constitutes a disciplinary matter that may result in progressive discipline up to and including termination of employment.



## 9C. BEREAVEMENT LEAVE POLICY

### 9C.1 Purpose

Evergreen Community Care recognizes that the loss of a loved one requires time to grieve, attend to family responsibilities, and participate in cultural and memorial practices. This policy provides paid bereavement leave as an expression of the organization's care for its employees as whole people.

### 9C.2 Paid Bereavement Leave Entitlement

| Relationship to Deceased                                                                   | Paid Leave Entitlement                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Spouse or common-law partner                                                               | 5 working days                                                                       |
| Child, stepchild, or child of common-law partner                                           | 5 working days                                                                       |
| Parent or stepparent                                                                       | 5 working days                                                                       |
| Sibling or stepsibling                                                                     | 3 working days                                                                       |
| Grandparent or grandchild                                                                  | 3 working days                                                                       |
| Parent-in-law, sibling-in-law, or child-in-law                                             | 3 working days                                                                       |
| Aunt, uncle, niece, nephew                                                                 | 1 working day                                                                        |
| Other close relative or relationship of significance                                       | 1–3 days at supervisor discretion with HR approval                                   |
| Indigenous employees: loss of Elder, Knowledge Keeper, or community member of significance | Up to 3 working days, assessed with cultural sensitivity and in consultation with HR |

### 9C.3 Extended Leave for Travel

Where significant travel is required to attend a funeral, memorial service, or traditional ceremony, additional unpaid leave of up to two (2) working days may be approved by the supervisor. Employees needing additional time beyond these provisions may request additional unpaid leave or use accrued vacation time.

### 9C.4 Flexible Scheduling in Grief

Evergreen Community Care recognizes that grief does not follow a fixed timeline. Supervisors are encouraged to work with flexibility and compassion with employees managing bereavement, including approving temporary schedule modifications, adjusted duties, or referral to the EFAP counselling program where operationally possible.

### 9C.5 Notification

Employees should notify their supervisor of a bereavement absence as soon as practicable. Documentation (e.g., obituary, funeral program) may be requested in cases where the leave



duration or relationship is unclear, but will be handled with sensitivity and not requested unless necessary.



## 9D. ACCOMMODATION POLICY

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### 9D.1 Purpose and Legislative Basis

Evergreen Community Care has a legal and ethical duty under the BC Human Rights Code to accommodate employees with disabilities, family status obligations, religious observance requirements, and other protected characteristics, to the point of undue hardship. This policy establishes a clear, respectful, and timely process for workplace accommodation.

### 9D.2 Protected Grounds Covered

This policy applies to accommodation requests related to any ground protected under the BC Human Rights Code, including but not limited to:

- Physical or mental disability (including temporary medical conditions, chronic illness, and mental health diagnoses)
- Family status obligations (including primary caregiving responsibilities for children or dependent adults)
- Pregnancy and breastfeeding
- Religious or spiritual observance and practice
- Any other ground protected under the BC Human Rights Code

### 9D.3 How to Request Accommodation

Employees who require a workplace accommodation are encouraged to submit a written accommodation request to Human Resources or their supervisor as early as possible. The request should describe the functional need or limitation and the type of accommodation being sought. Employees are not required to disclose their specific diagnosis; functional limitations are sufficient.

### 9D.4 Accommodation Process

- Human Resources acknowledges the request within five (5) business days
- A collaborative meeting is arranged with the employee, their supervisor, and Human Resources to explore accommodation options
- The employee's health care provider may be asked to provide a functional limitations assessment (not a diagnosis) to support planning
- An Accommodation Plan is developed in writing, signed by the employee and Human Resources, and reviewed at agreed intervals
- The plan is updated as the employee's functional needs or circumstances change

### 9D.5 Duty to Participate

Accommodation is a collaborative process. The employee has a duty to participate in good faith, including: disclosing sufficient information to allow planning; cooperating with the assessment process; and considering reasonable accommodation options even if they are not the employee's preferred solution. Failure to participate in good faith may limit the organization's duty to accommodate.

### 9D.6 Undue Hardship

Accommodation is provided up to the point of undue hardship. Factors relevant to undue hardship include significant financial cost, serious health and safety risk to the employee or to



children and youth in care, and fundamental operational disruption. Undue hardship determinations require thorough analysis, consultation with Human Resources and legal counsel, and are documented in writing before any accommodation refusal is communicated.

### **9D.7 Confidentiality**

Accommodation information, including functional limitation assessments, is confidential. It is shared only with those who have a direct operational need to know in order to implement the accommodation plan. Medical or clinical information is not disclosed to supervisors or colleagues without the employee's explicit written consent.

## 9E. CRITICAL INCIDENT STRESS MANAGEMENT POLICY

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### 9E.1 Purpose

Residential care staff regularly encounter events involving serious harm, violence, medical emergencies, and the acute distress of children and youth with complex trauma histories. This policy ensures all staff have access to structured, timely support following critical incidents as a core component of Evergreen Community Care's commitment to staff wellness and secondary trauma prevention.

### 9E.2 Definition of Critical Incident

For the purpose of this policy, a critical incident is any event that has the potential to overwhelm an individual's normal coping mechanisms and produce significant acute stress responses.

Examples include:

- Serious physical assault on a staff member causing injury or significant distress
- Death or serious injury of a child, youth, or colleague at or connected to the workplace
- Suicide attempt or death by suicide of a child or youth currently or recently in care
- Major fire, vehicle accident, or natural disaster affecting the facility or staff while on duty
- Extended or severe behavioural crisis requiring physical intervention or emergency services
- Discovery of serious abuse, exploitation, or trafficking involving a youth in care
- Any event that a supervisor, Program Manager, or affected employee identifies as requiring structured debrief support

### 9E.3 Immediate Response: Defusing (Within 24 Hours)

Within twenty-four (24) hours of a critical incident, the Program Manager ensures that all directly involved staff are offered an informal defusing session. The defusing is a brief, structured conversation (30–60 minutes) that provides: immediate stabilization of acute stress reactions; practical information about normal stress responses; connection to further support; and temporary modified duties if indicated.

### 9E.4 Formal Debrief (48 to 72 Hours)

Within forty-eight (48) to seventy-two (72) hours of a significant critical incident, a structured Critical Incident Stress Debrief (CISD) is offered to all involved staff. The debrief is facilitated by the Program Manager for lower-severity incidents, or by an external mental health clinician with CISD training for major incidents. Attendance is strongly encouraged but is not mandatory.

### 9E.5 Ongoing Clinical Support

Following a major critical incident, staff may access trauma-focused counselling through the Employee and Family Assistance Program (EFAP) at no cost to the employee. The organization may also arrange, at its own expense, additional clinical sessions beyond the standard EFAP allocation where the incident is assessed as having major organizational impact.

### 9E.6 Return to High-Demand Duties

Staff affected by a critical incident must not be returned to high-demand or high-acuity shifts without supervisor confirmation that they are ready and able to do so safely. A brief wellness check-in with the supervisor or Program Manager is conducted before an affected employee returns to full duties. Supervisors who are themselves directly affected by a critical incident must



delegate supervisory responsibilities to a qualified designate before returning to decision-making duties.



## 10A. EMPLOYEE ASSISTANCE PROGRAM (EAP) POLICY

### 10A.1 Program Overview

Evergreen Community Care provides access to a confidential Employee and Family Assistance Program (EFAP) for all employees and their immediate family members. Access to the EFAP is available from the first day of employment, regardless of employment category, probationary status, or hours worked.

### 10A.2 Services Available Through the EFAP

| Service                | Description                                                                                                  |
|------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Short-term counselling | Individual, couples, and family counselling (typically 6–8 sessions per presenting concern per benefit year) |
| Mental health support  | Anxiety, depression, grief, trauma, burnout, and relationship difficulties                                   |
| Crisis support         | Available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week, by telephone                                                        |
| Legal consultation     | One initial session per legal matter                                                                         |
| Financial counselling  | Budgeting, debt management, and financial planning                                                           |
| Nutrition and wellness | Registered dietitian consultations and wellness coaching                                                     |
| Work-life resources    | Childcare and elder care referrals, community support navigation                                             |

### 10A.3 Confidentiality Guarantee

All EFAP services are strictly confidential. Evergreen Community Care does not receive any information about which employees access the program, the frequency of use, or the nature of the issues being addressed. The only exception to confidentiality is where the EFAP provider is legally required to disclose information due to imminent risk of serious harm to the employee or another person. Use of the EFAP has no bearing on employment status, performance evaluations, or disciplinary decisions.

### 10A.4 How to Access the EFAP

EFAP contact information is provided to all employees at orientation, posted in staff areas at all facilities, and included in the onboarding package. Employees may self-refer at any time by calling the EFAP directly. Neither supervisor approval nor HR notification is required to access the program. The EFAP contact number is also available through Human Resources at any time.

### 10A.5 Supervisory Referrals

Supervisors may bring information about the EFAP to an employee's attention and encourage its use when they observe signs of stress, difficulty, or declining wellbeing. A supervisory referral is informational and supportive only; supervisors may not mandate participation in EFAP services as a condition of employment. A formal fitness-for-duty assessment, where clinically warranted, is a separate process governed by Human Resources and medical professionals.

### 10A.6 EFAP During Critical Incidents



Following major critical incidents, Human Resources or the Program Manager will actively connect affected staff with EFAP services as part of the Critical Incident Stress Management response (Section 9E). In such cases, the organization may arrange a group or individual EFAP session at its expense in addition to standard EFAP access.

## 10B. WORKPLACE VIOLENCE PREVENTION PROGRAM

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### 10B.1 Purpose and Regulatory Basis

This section documents Evergreen Community Care's written Workplace Violence Prevention Program as required under Sections 4.27 through 4.31 of the BC Occupational Health and Safety Regulation. It supplements the general provisions contained in Section 15.4 of this binder and provides the operational detail required by WorkSafeBC.

### 10B.2 Annual Violence Risk Assessment

The Program Manager, in consultation with the Joint Health and Safety Committee, conducts a written workplace violence risk assessment at each facility annually and whenever significant changes in the client population, staffing model, or physical environment occur. The assessment considers:

- Nature of the client population served: trauma history, known behavioural risk factors, mental health diagnoses, history of aggression
- Physical layout of each facility: sightlines, isolation risks, access control, proximity to emergency exits
- Staffing levels and supervision patterns at each time of day and day of week
- History of violent incidents at the facility over the preceding twelve (12) months
- Identified high-risk situations: transitions, mealtimes, bedtime routines, community outings

### 10B.3 Violence Prevention Measures

Based on the risk assessment findings, the following prevention controls are implemented as applicable at each facility:

- Individual Behaviour Support Plans for youth with a documented history of physical aggression, reviewed and updated by the Program Manager at each ISP review period
- Staff-to-youth ratios maintained at levels that allow safe de-escalation and intervention without staff isolation
- Check-in protocols for staff working late-night or isolated areas of the facility
- Communication devices (phone, walkie-talkie, or personal alarm) available to all on-duty staff at all times
- Physical facility design reviewed annually by the Program Manager to reduce blind spots and isolated areas
- Mandatory Non-Violent Crisis Intervention training for all direct-care staff

### 10B.4 Reporting and Post-Incident Requirements

All violent incidents, including threats, intimidation, property damage with an implicit threat, and physical assaults (regardless of injury level), are reported immediately to the supervisor and documented on the Incident Report form within twenty-four (24) hours. The JHSC reviews all violence-related incident reports at monthly meetings and recommends corrective actions. Post-incident support follows Section 9E (Critical Incident Stress Management).

### 10B.5 Worker Rights

No worker will be required to work in conditions where they face an immediate and unmitigated risk of physical violence. Workers may exercise the Right to Refuse Unsafe Work under Section



15.6 in response to a specific and immediate violence threat, without fear of reprisal. Supervisors must take all violence concerns raised by staff seriously and document the response.



## **10C. SOCIAL MEDIA AND ELECTRONIC COMMUNICATIONS POLICY**

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### **10C.1 Purpose**

This policy establishes standards for employee use of social media and electronic communications to protect the privacy and dignity of children and youth in care, preserve organizational reputation, and ensure compliance with the Freedom of Information and Protection of Privacy Act (FOIPPA), the Personal Information Protection Act (PIPA), and the Child, Family and Community Service Act.

### **10C.2 Scope**

This policy applies to all employees, contractors, and volunteers of Evergreen Community Care and covers all social media platforms, messaging applications, and online forums, whether accessed on organizational devices, personal devices, during work hours, or during personal time, where the content relates to the organization, its programs, or the children and youth it serves.

### **10C.3 Absolute Prohibitions**

The following conduct is strictly prohibited and constitutes grounds for immediate suspension and may result in termination of employment without notice:

- Posting, sharing, transmitting, or storing any photograph, video, or identifying information relating to a child or youth in care on any platform or device
- Disclosing the name, location, physical description, family relationships, or placement history of any child or youth in care
- Sharing information about incidents, behavioural events, or circumstances involving children or youth, even without using names or other obvious identifiers
- Connecting with, accepting friend or follower requests from, or initiating social media contact with current or former clients of Evergreen Community Care
- Posting content that brings Evergreen Community Care, MCFD, or the residential care sector into disrepute

### **10C.4 Professional Conduct Online**

Employees are expected to conduct themselves professionally in all online environments. Content that would violate the Code of Conduct or the Anti-Harassment Policy in person also violates those policies when posted online. Employees are reminded that content described as private, restricted, or posted to a closed group may still reach unintended audiences, including clients, families, MCFD licensing staff, and the general public.

### **10C.5 Personal Device Use During Shifts**

Personal mobile devices are not to be used for social media browsing, personal messaging, or any non-work-related communication during active shifts when staff are responsible for the supervision of children or youth. Brief personal telephone calls during scheduled breaks are permitted. Photographing children or youth on personal devices is prohibited at all times, including when staff are on-site during off-duty hours.

### **10C.6 Organizational Social Media**

Only staff expressly designated and authorized by the Executive Director may post content on behalf of Evergreen Community Care on official organizational social media accounts or



websites. Employees may not represent themselves as speaking on behalf of the organization in any public online forum without prior written authorization from the Executive Director.

## 10D. RESPECTFUL WORKPLACE POLICY

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### 10D.1 Commitment

Evergreen Community Care is committed to maintaining a workplace free from bullying, harassment, intimidation, and all forms of disrespectful conduct. This commitment reflects both our legal obligations under the BC Workers Compensation Act and WorkSafeBC Policies and our values as an organization dedicated to the dignity of every person, including our own employees.

### 10D.2 Definition of Workplace Bullying and Harassment

Consistent with WorkSafeBC Policy D3-115-2, workplace bullying and harassment means any conduct by a person toward a worker in the workplace that the person knew or reasonably ought to have known would cause the worker to be humiliated or intimidated, and includes repeated conduct or a single serious act. Examples include:

- Repeated hurtful, demeaning, or abusive remarks or written communications
- Social or professional exclusion without legitimate organizational justification
- Intimidating behaviour, threats, or conduct that creates a climate of fear
- Deliberately overloading an employee with unreasonable workloads without support, or conversely removing meaningful work without explanation
- Spreading false information, rumours, or malicious gossip about a colleague
- Public humiliation or demeaning criticism of an employee in front of their team or clients

### 10D.3 What Does Not Constitute Bullying and Harassment

Reasonable management actions carried out appropriately and in good faith are not bullying and harassment. These include: providing work direction and performance feedback; managing attendance or productivity concerns; issuing appropriate disciplinary measures in response to conduct or performance issues; and making operational decisions about staffing, scheduling, or program assignments.

### 10D.4 Reporting and Investigation

Employees who experience or witness workplace bullying or harassment are encouraged to report the behaviour to their supervisor, the Director of Human Resources, or the Executive Director. Where the alleged harasser is the employee's supervisor, the report is made directly to Human Resources or the Executive Director. All complaints are investigated promptly, fairly, impartially, and with appropriate confidentiality. Both the complainant and the respondent are entitled to be informed of the allegations, have an opportunity to respond, and receive a written outcome.

### 10D.5 Prohibition on Retaliation

No employee will face retaliation, adverse employment action, or negative treatment for making a good-faith complaint of bullying or harassment, or for participating as a witness in an investigation. Retaliation against a complainant or witness is itself a serious disciplinary offence that may result in termination of employment. Employees who believe they are experiencing retaliation should report this immediately to Human Resources.

### 10D.6 Employer Obligations



Evergreen Community Care fulfils its employer obligations under WorkSafeBC Policy D3-115-2 by: maintaining this written policy; providing annual training to all staff and supervisors on recognizing and preventing workplace bullying and harassment; investigating all formal complaints; taking corrective action where harassment is substantiated; and annually reviewing the effectiveness of prevention measures.



## **10E. WORKING ALONE OR IN ISOLATION POLICY**

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### **10E.1 Regulatory Basis**

This policy fulfils Evergreen Community Care's obligations under Sections 4.21 through 4.24 of the BC Occupational Health and Safety Regulation regarding workers who work alone or in isolation in circumstances where assistance may not be readily available in the event of an injury, illness, or emergency.

### **10E.2 Identification of Working-Alone Situations**

The Program Manager maintains a current register of roles and work circumstances within Evergreen Community Care that involve working alone or in isolation. The register is reviewed and updated annually and whenever significant changes occur in staffing patterns, facility use, or the client population. Working-alone situations may include: single-staff overnight shifts; staff working alone in an office or administrative area after hours; and staff conducting activities in areas of the facility with limited sightlines or communication access.

### **10E.3 Risk Assessment**

For each identified working-alone situation, a risk assessment is conducted by the Program Manager in consultation with the JHSC. The assessment considers: the nature of the tasks performed while alone; the vulnerability of the client population present; communication options available in the area; history of incidents in the location; and estimated emergency response time from the nearest available assistance.

### **10E.4 Control Measures**

Based on the risk assessment outcome, one or more of the following control measures is implemented for each working-alone situation:

- Scheduled check-in system: the worker contacts a designated person (supervisor, on-call manager, or after-hours contact) at defined intervals not to exceed two (2) hours; if a check-in is missed, the designate follows the escalating emergency response protocol immediately
- Personal communication device: a fully charged phone, two-way radio, or personal alarm device is provided to the worker and confirmed functional at the beginning of each shift
- Modified scheduling: where risk assessment indicates that a specific task cannot be performed safely alone, minimum two-staff coverage is required
- Environmental controls: physical layout modifications (improved lighting, removal of blind spots) to reduce isolation risk

### **10E.5 Emergency Response Protocol**

A written emergency response protocol is maintained at each facility. The protocol specifies: the designated check-in contact by shift and by day; the escalation steps when a check-in is missed (attempt phone contact; contact second designate; contact 911; notify Program Manager); and the chain of notification following any emergency response. Protocols are reviewed annually and posted at each facility.

### **10E.6 Documentation and JHSC Review**



Working-alone check-in records are maintained at each facility using the designated log sheet. The JHSC reviews these records during monthly inspections and reports any compliance gaps to the Program Manager. Systematic non-compliance with check-in procedures is treated as a workplace safety matter and addressed through the OHS program.

## 10F. IMPAIRMENT AND SUBSTANCE USE POLICY

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### 10F.1 Purpose

The safety of children and youth in Evergreen Community Care's residential programs requires that all employees are fully fit for duty throughout every shift. This policy addresses impairment from alcohol, cannabis, illicit substances, and prescription or over-the-counter medication, and does so in a manner consistent with the BC Human Rights Code, the Workers Compensation Act, and contemporary harm-reduction principles.

### 10F.2 Fitness for Duty Standard

All employees are required to report to and remain fit for duty throughout their entire scheduled shift. An employee is considered impaired when their ability to safely perform assigned duties is affected by any substance, including alcohol, cannabis, controlled substances, or prescription and over-the-counter medication that produce sedation, impaired reaction time, or reduced cognitive function.

### 10F.3 Prohibited Conduct

- Reporting for duty while impaired by any substance, regardless of whether impairment was caused by recreational or prescribed medication use
- Consuming alcohol within eight (8) hours of the start of a scheduled shift, or twelve (12) hours for any shift involving the operation of a vehicle
- Consuming cannabis within twelve (12) hours of the start of any scheduled shift
- Consuming controlled substances not prescribed by a licensed health care provider at any time before or during a shift
- Being in possession of illicit substances on organizational property or in organizational vehicles, or while transporting clients
- Consuming alcohol, cannabis, or any controlled substance on organizational property during a shift or during any work-related travel

### 10F.4 Prescription and Over-the-Counter Medication

Employees taking prescription or over-the-counter medication that may impair alertness, reaction time, motor coordination, or judgment are required to inform their supervisor prior to the start of their shift, so that modified duties or other accommodations can be considered. Employees are not required to disclose the specific medication; confirmation from a pharmacist or prescriber that the medication may impair work performance is sufficient. Supervisors must treat this disclosure with full confidentiality.

### 10F.5 Reasonable Grounds Assessment

Where a supervisor has reasonable grounds to believe that an employee may be impaired while on duty (based on observable indicators: slurred speech, unsteady gait, impaired judgment, unusual odour, or self-disclosure), the supervisor will remove the employee from direct client contact immediately and conduct a private, respectful conversation. The employee may be relieved of duty for the remainder of the shift. A formal investigation follows, conducted by Human Resources in accordance with the Progressive Discipline Policy (Section 13).

### 10F.6 Duty to Accommodate Substance Dependency



Substance use disorder and addiction are recognized as disabilities under the BC Human Rights Code. Where an employee voluntarily discloses a dependency or addiction, Evergreen Community Care fulfils its duty to accommodate to the point of undue hardship. Accommodation may include: support in accessing the EFAP and external addiction treatment; medical leave to attend a treatment program; and a structured graduated return-to-work plan developed jointly with HR, the employee, and the treating health care provider. An employee who voluntarily discloses a substance dependency and actively engages in treatment will not be subject to progressive discipline for the underlying disclosure alone.



## 11A. SHIFT HANDOVER AND COMMUNICATION POLICY

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### 11A.1 Purpose

Clear and complete communication at every shift transition is critical to the safety and continuity of care for children and youth. This policy establishes minimum standards for shift handovers at all Evergreen Community Care residential facilities.

### 11A.2 Mandatory Overlap Period

A minimum handover overlap of fifteen (15) minutes between outgoing and incoming shifts is required at every transition. Both outgoing and incoming staff are considered on duty during this period and are jointly responsible for the wellbeing of all youth.

### 11A.3 Required Handover Content

Every handover must address the following items in order. Outgoing staff are responsible for communicating all items clearly before departing:

- Current location, status, and wellbeing of each child or youth in the home
- Incidents, behaviours, or significant events during the outgoing shift, including actions taken and outcomes
- Medications administered, including any doses missed, refused, or administered outside schedule
- Medical appointments, school attendance, or community activities completed or outstanding
- Outstanding tasks, follow-up items, and communications from MCFD, family members, or other professionals
- Any safety concerns, environmental hazards, or immediate changes to a Behaviour Support Plan
- Schedule changes, staffing gaps, or on-call information for the incoming shift

### 11A.4 Written Shift Log

Every shift is documented in the facility shift log before the outgoing staff member departs. The log is signed by outgoing staff and reviewed by the incoming shift lead. Shift logs are legal documents subject to MCFD inspection at any time.

### 11A.5 When a Handover Cannot Occur

If an incoming replacement has not arrived, the outgoing staff member must remain on duty and contact the on-call supervisor immediately. No staff member may leave the facility without a qualified replacement on site. Leaving the facility without a replacement is grounds for immediate disciplinary action.

### 11A.6 Supervision During Handover

Youth must be actively supervised throughout the handover period. Staff conduct a joint walkthrough of all areas at the end of the overlap period to confirm each youth is safe and accounted for.



## 11B. DOCUMENTATION AND RECORD-KEEPING POLICY

### 11B.1 Purpose

Accurate, timely, and professional documentation is a core responsibility for all residential care staff. Records support continuity of care, demonstrate MCFD licensing compliance, and provide legal protection for staff and the organization.

### 11B.2 General Documentation Standards

- Documentation uses clear, objective, professional language; personal opinions, labels, and derogatory terms are not used
- Observations are recorded as observations, not inferences or assumptions about a youth's motivations
- All records are dated, timed, and signed or electronically authenticated by the author
- Records are completed as close as possible to the time of the event and before the end of the shift
- Errors in paper records are corrected by a single strikethrough, initials, and correct information written alongside; white-out is prohibited
- Electronic records are not altered after submission without supervisor authorization and a documented amendment note

### 11B.3 Minimum Required Documentation

| Record Type                            | Frequency or Trigger                                                                   |
|----------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Shift log                              | Every shift, before outgoing staff depart                                              |
| Daily observation note per youth       | Every shift the youth is present in the home                                           |
| Medication Administration Record (MAR) | Every administration, including PRN medications                                        |
| Incident Report                        | Within 24 hours of any incident; within 2 hours for MCFD-reportable Critical Incidents |
| Transport log                          | Every trip with a child or youth as passenger                                          |
| Behaviour Support Plan notation        | Any time a BSP strategy is used or a target behaviour occurs                           |
| Communication log                      | All contacts with MCFD, family members, schools, or other professionals                |
| Case conference notes                  | Within 48 hours of any formal meeting about a youth's care                             |

### 11B.4 Prohibited Documentation Practices

- Recording information about one youth in another youth's file
- Using abbreviations not on the organization's approved list
- Documenting events from memory after forty-eight (48) hours without a supervisor-approved late entry notation
- Sharing documentation outside the facility without supervisor approval or MCFD authorization



## **11B.5 Records Privacy and Access**

Youth records are confidential and accessible only to staff with a direct care role for that youth, the Program Manager, and authorized MCFD staff. Electronic systems must be locked when unattended.

### **11B.6 Retention**

Youth care records are retained for a minimum of seven (7) years following departure from the program, or until the youth reaches age nineteen (19), whichever is longer.



## **11C. MEDICATION MANAGEMENT DAILY PROCEDURES POLICY**

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### **11C.1 Purpose**

This policy establishes daily operational procedures for the safe storage, administration, documentation, and disposal of medications for children and youth in care, supplementing the Residential Care Policy Manual medication provisions.

### **11C.2 Authorization to Administer**

Only staff who have completed Evergreen Community Care's Medication Administration training and whose authorization is current on file with the Program Manager may administer medications. Staff with lapsed authorization may not administer medications until re-authorized.

### **11C.3 Daily Administration Procedures**

- Medications are retrieved from locked storage at the time of administration only and returned immediately after use
- Before every dose, the administering staff member verifies: the youth's full name; medication name and strength; prescribed dose; prescribed time and route; and the Medication Administration Record (MAR) instructions
- The five rights are confirmed for every dose: right youth, right medication, right dose, right route, right time
- The administration is documented on the MAR immediately; the youth is observed taking the medication before documentation occurs
- No medication is pre-poured, pre-drawn, or left unattended

### **11C.4 Missed, Refused, or Vomited Doses**

- Missed dose: document immediately on the MAR with reason; notify supervisor
- Refused dose: document on MAR with youth's stated reason; notify supervisor if clinically significant or repeated
- Vomited within 30 minutes: contact supervisor and prescriber before repeating; document

### **11C.5 Medication Storage**

- All medications stored in a locked cabinet or safe; refrigerated medications in a locked section of the refrigerator, separate from food
- Medication storage key or access code transferred as part of every shift handover
- Controlled substances require double-lock storage and count verification by both outgoing and incoming staff at every handover

### **11C.6 Medication Errors**

Any error (wrong dose, wrong time, wrong youth, wrong medication, missed dose) is reported immediately to the on-call supervisor. A Medication Error Report is completed within two (2) hours. Repeated errors may result in suspension of medication authorization pending retraining.

### **11C.7 Medication Disposal**



Expired or discontinued medications are removed from the active MAR immediately and disposed of through a pharmacy take-back program. Medications are not flushed or placed in general waste. Disposal is documented.



## **11D. TELEPHONE AND COMMUNICATION DEVICE USE POLICY**

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### **11D.1 Purpose**

This policy governs the use of organizational and personal telephones and communication devices during work hours to ensure attentive care, professional communications, and the protection of youth privacy.

### **11D.2 Organizational Phone Use**

- Facility phones are for work-related communication during shift hours
- Incoming calls are answered: “Evergreen Community Care, [first name] speaking”
- All calls from MCFD, family members, healthcare providers, or schools are logged in the communication log: caller name, time, purpose, and action taken
- Staff must not confirm or deny a specific youth’s placement to any caller until the caller’s identity and authorization are verified

### **11D.3 Personal Mobile Phone Use During Shifts**

- Personal phones are stored out of sight (bag or locker, not on the person) during active supervision periods
- Personal calls and texts are permitted during scheduled breaks only, in a staff area away from youth
- Photographing, video-recording, or audio-recording youth using a personal device is strictly prohibited at all times

### **11D.4 On-Call Communication**

- On-call staff must be reachable by phone within thirty (30) minutes of contact throughout their on-call period
- On-call staff who are unable to respond due to illness or emergency must notify the supervisor immediately so alternate coverage can be arranged

### **11D.5 Confidentiality in Communications**

Confidential information about a youth’s placement, background, or family must not be discussed where it may be overheard by other youth, visitors, or the public. Speakerphone conversations involving confidential information require a private, closed-door setting.



## **11E. PETTY CASH AND YOUTH ALLOWANCE MANAGEMENT POLICY**

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### **11E.1 Purpose**

This policy governs the handling of organizational petty cash, youth personal allowances, and program activity funds to ensure financial accountability and protect the rights of children and youth to their own personal funds.

### **11E.2 Petty Cash Fund**

- Each facility maintains a petty cash fund (typically \$200–\$300) in a locked cash box; access is limited to the on-duty shift lead
- Every expenditure requires a dated, signed receipt; petty cash is not used for personal purchases or loans to staff
- Petty cash is reconciled at each shift handover; any discrepancy is reported to the Program Manager immediately
- Replenishment is through Finance upon submission of receipts and a completed Petty Cash Reconciliation form

### **11E.3 Youth Personal Allowances**

- Youth allowances are kept in individual, labeled, secure envelopes or a locked individual cash box, separate from program petty cash
- Youth have the right to use their allowance for lawful purposes of their choosing; allowance is never withheld as discipline
- Every transaction is documented in the youth's individual funds ledger: date, amount, purpose, and staff witness signature
- Youth personal funds are counted and reconciled weekly by the shift lead and signed off by the Program Manager

### **11E.4 Activity and Program Funds**

Program activity funds are tracked separately from petty cash and youth allowances. A program activity receipt log is maintained and submitted to the Program Manager monthly. All activity expenditures above \$50 per event require prior Program Manager approval.

### **11E.5 Missing or Disputed Funds**

Any discrepancy in petty cash or youth funds is reported to the Program Manager immediately and investigated. Theft of youth personal funds is grounds for immediate termination and may be referred to police.



## 11F. VISITORS, GUESTS, AND FACILITY SECURITY POLICY

### 11F.1 Purpose

This policy governs access to Evergreen Community Care residential facilities by visitors, family members, contractors, and other guests to ensure the safety and privacy of all children and youth in care.

### 11F.2 Authorized Visitor Categories

| Visitor Category                              | Entry Conditions                                                            |
|-----------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| MCFD social worker or licensing officer       | Verify ID; immediate access permitted; log visit                            |
| Authorized family member                      | Verify against care plan; confirm visit authorized; supervise per care plan |
| Healthcare provider                           | Verify appointment in youth's file; log visit                               |
| Organizational staff (HR, Executive Director) | Welcome; log visit                                                          |
| Pre-approved contractor or tradesperson       | Verify CRC on file; never left alone with youth                             |
| Practicum student or volunteer                | Confirm orientation complete; never left alone with youth                   |

### 11F.3 Visitor Sign-In and Identification

- All visitors sign the visitor log: name, relationship, purpose, arrival and departure time
- Staff ask for photo ID for any visitor not personally known to them
- Visitors are escorted at all times and not left alone in any area of the home

### 11F.4 Unauthorized Visitors

- Any unrecognized or unauthorized visitor waits at the door while the supervisor is contacted
- If a visitor refuses identification, becomes threatening, or forces entry, call 911 immediately and notify the supervisor
- Staff must never disclose which youth live in the facility to any unauthorized visitor

### 11F.5 Youth's Own Guests

Youth may receive guests consistent with their Individual Service Plan. All personal guest visits require prior supervisor approval and must be supervised. Overnight guests require Program Manager approval and written MCFD social worker authorization.

### 11F.6 Facility Security

- All exterior doors are locked at all times; staff verify visitors before unlocking
- Keys and access codes are never shared with youth or unauthorized persons
- Lost keys are reported to the supervisor immediately; the Program Manager determines whether re-keying is required



## 11G. YOUTH MISSING FROM CARE PROTOCOL

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### 11G.1 Purpose

This protocol establishes the immediate and documented response required when a child or youth is missing from care. Timely action protects the youth's safety and fulfills mandatory obligations to MCFD and law enforcement.

### 11G.2 When This Protocol Applies

This protocol activates when a youth: does not return from an outing at the agreed time; cannot be located within the facility after an immediate search; leaves without staff knowledge or authorization; or contacts staff to say they will not return.

### 11G.3 Immediate Response Steps

- Step 1: Conduct a full facility and grounds safety check (maximum 5 minutes)
- Step 2: Contact people the youth is known to visit: friends, family, frequented locations
- Step 3: Notify the on-call supervisor or Program Manager immediately by telephone
- Step 4: Contact the youth's MCFD social worker (or after-hours duty worker) within one (1) hour
- Step 5: Call 911 to report the youth as missing. For high-risk youth, call 911 immediately without waiting for Steps 2–4
- Step 6: Complete a Missing Youth Report form and maintain a chronological log of all actions taken

### 11G.4 High-Risk Classification (Immediate 911)

- Any youth under twelve (12) years of age
- Any youth with a documented history of suicidal ideation or active crisis
- Any youth assessed as at risk of trafficking or exploitation
- Any youth with a significant medical condition requiring medication or treatment

### 11G.5 When the Youth Returns

On return: conduct a wellness check and provide a non-judgmental welcome; assess for injury, intoxication, or distress; notify supervisor, MCFD, and police (to cancel the missing person report); document the return; and schedule a debrief with the youth within 24 hours to review and update the care plan.

### 11G.6 Documentation

A complete Missing Youth Report is submitted to the Program Manager within 24 hours. This is a Critical Incident reportable to MCFD. All staff actions and times are documented precisely.



## 11H. COMMUNITY OUTINGS AND ACTIVITY SAFETY POLICY

### 11H.1 Purpose

Community participation and recreational activities are essential to the wellbeing of children and youth in residential care. This policy ensures all outings are planned and conducted safely and consistently with each youth's individual care plan.

### 11H.2 Planning Requirements

- Community outings are reflected in the weekly program schedule, reviewed by the shift lead at the beginning of each week
- Outings involving travel beyond the immediate neighbourhood require prior supervisor approval
- New or unfamiliar venues are assessed for safety considerations before use
- Each youth's ISP is reviewed to confirm any access restrictions, required supervision ratios, safety considerations, and whether MCFD consent is required

### 11H.3 Staffing Ratios for Outings

| Outing Type                                            | Minimum Staffing Ratio                            |
|--------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|
| Low risk: local walk, familiar park, 2–3 youth         | 1 staff to 3 youth                                |
| Moderate risk: shopping, community pool, transit       | 1 staff to 2 youth                                |
| Higher risk: water activities, camping, large events   | 1 staff to 1 youth (or as assessed)               |
| Any youth with BSP indicating physical aggression risk | 1 staff to 1 youth minimum, regardless of setting |
| Any youth under 10 years of age                        | 1 staff to 2 youth maximum                        |

### 11H.4 During the Outing

- Head count of all youth: before departing; on arrival; every 30 minutes; before departing the destination; and on return to the facility
- Emergency contact numbers, facility address, and participant list carried by the lead staff at all times
- Each youth's emergency medication (EpiPen, puffer, seizure medication) brought if applicable, confirmed before departure

### 11H.5 Water Activities

All water-based activities require: written MCFD consent for each youth; documented swimming ability assessment; PFDs for non-swimmers; at least one staff with water safety training; and a registered lifeguard at all pool facilities.



## 11I. EMERGENCY PROCEDURES AND EVACUATION DRILLS POLICY

### 11I.1 Purpose

All Evergreen Community Care residential facilities maintain written emergency procedures and conduct regular drills to ensure staff and youth respond safely to fires, medical emergencies, power outages, and other emergency situations.

### 11I.2 Posted Emergency Procedures

The following are printed, laminated, and posted at each facility near exits and the main telephone:

- Fire evacuation plan with floor plan, exits, assembly point, and extinguisher locations
- Emergency contact list: 911; MCFD after-hours; Program Manager; Executive Director; facility address with cross-streets
- Missing youth protocol summary
- Medical emergency response steps
- Power outage procedures including location of flashlights and battery radio

### 11I.3 Fire Evacuation

- On any fire alarm activation, all occupants evacuate immediately via the posted route; elevators are never used
- The shift lead assigns staff roles before each shift: one staff leads youth to the assembly point; one staff sweeps all rooms; one staff calls 911 if not automatic
- Head count at the assembly point is reported to fire services on arrival; no one re-enters until cleared

### 11I.4 Drill Schedule

| Drill Type                                      | Required Frequency                           |
|-------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| Fire evacuation (announced)                     | Quarterly                                    |
| Fire evacuation (unannounced, night or weekend) | Annually                                     |
| Lockdown or shelter-in-place drill              | Annually                                     |
| Medical emergency tabletop review               | Annually (team meeting)                      |
| Missing youth protocol tabletop review          | Annually or after any missing youth incident |

### 11I.5 Medical Emergencies

- Call 911 immediately if the person is unconscious, not breathing, or in immediate danger
- Begin first aid; stay with the person until emergency services arrive; notify supervisor; document



- First aid kit inspected monthly; at least one staff per shift holds a current Level C First Aid certification

### **11I.6 Severe Weather and Utility Failures**

In a severe weather event or extended utility failure, the shift lead contacts the Program Manager immediately. The Program Manager determines whether youth must be temporarily relocated and coordinates with MCFD if needed.



## **11J. PROFESSIONAL BOUNDARIES IN RESIDENTIAL CARE POLICY**

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### **11J.1 Purpose**

Professional boundaries are the ethical framework defining the appropriate relationship between residential care staff and the children and youth in their care. Clear boundaries protect youth from harm, protect staff from allegations, and maintain the therapeutic integrity of the home.

### **11J.2 The Therapeutic Relationship**

Staff play an influential role in children's lives. The power differential between a care provider and a child in care is always present. Youth may seek to blur role boundaries as a result of trauma histories. It is always the staff member's professional responsibility to maintain appropriate limits, regardless of the youth's behaviour or expressed preferences.

### **11J.3 Appropriate Interactions**

- Treat every youth with warmth, dignity, and consistent respect regardless of their behaviour
- Physical contact is limited to what is therapeutically appropriate: brief, supportive contact initiated by the youth; lengthy or intimate contact is not appropriate
- Use each youth's preferred name and correct pronouns at all times
- Personal sharing with youth is limited to brief, age-appropriate information consistent with a professional relationship

### **11J.4 Prohibited Conduct**

- Exchanging personal contact information (phone number, personal email, social media) with a current or recently departed youth
- Giving personal gifts to individual youth outside of equitably distributed program gifts
- Meeting with a youth outside of scheduled activities without supervisor knowledge and approval
- Making promises to a youth that are outside the staff member's authority or cannot be fulfilled
- Discussing confidential information about one youth with another youth
- Using a relationship with a youth to meet the staff member's own emotional or social needs

### **11J.5 Dual Relationships**

A staff member who discovers a pre-existing personal connection to a youth in care must disclose this immediately to the Program Manager, who determines whether a placement change or reassignment is required.

### **11J.6 Boundary Concerns**

Staff experiencing difficulty maintaining boundaries or developing unusual attachment to a youth are encouraged to raise this in supervision. Early disclosure is not disciplinary. Boundary violations are subject to progressive discipline up to termination. Suspected abuse or exploitation is reported to MCFD as required by the CFCSA.



## 11K. CULTURAL SAFETY IN DAILY PRACTICE POLICY

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### 11K.1 Purpose

Cultural safety is the daily practice of creating an environment in which every child, youth, and family feels safe to bring their full cultural identity. This policy operationalizes Evergreen Community Care's commitment to cultural safety in residential care, with particular attention to Indigenous children and youth.

### 11K.2 Every Staff Member's Daily Responsibility

- Address each youth by their correct preferred name and pronouns without exception
- Never make assumptions about a youth's cultural identity based on appearance or family name
- Actively support a youth's access to cultural practices, languages, foods, ceremonies, and community connections as identified in their care plan
- Refrain from comments, jokes, or expressions that stereotype or diminish any cultural, ethnic, racial, or Indigenous identity

### 11K.3 Indigenous Youth: Specific Obligations

Evergreen Community Care acknowledges the ongoing impacts of colonization and the overrepresentation of Indigenous children in care. For all Indigenous youth, staff must:

- Document and actively support community connection and band or Nation affiliation
- Facilitate access to cultural liaisons, Elders, and cultural support workers identified in the ISP
- Incorporate traditional foods into meal planning where requested
- Accommodate smudging, prayer, or other spiritual practices in the home without judgment

### 11K.4 Language Access

Where a youth or family communicates primarily in a language other than English, the Program Manager arranges interpreter support for significant meetings or incident discussions. Youth are never used as interpreters for adult communications.

### 11K.5 Raising Cultural Safety Concerns

Staff who observe a practice or comment that may compromise a youth's cultural safety report it to the supervisor through the shift log. Patterns of conduct are addressed through reflective supervision and, where warranted, progressive discipline.



## 11L. SELF-HARM AND SUICIDAL CRISIS RESPONSE PROTOCOL

### 11L.1 Purpose

Children and youth in residential care have significantly elevated rates of self-harm and suicidal ideation. This protocol establishes the immediate, documented, and therapeutically grounded response when a youth is in crisis.

### 11L.2 Immediate Safety Response

- Stay calm and remain with the youth; do not leave them alone
- Remove access to means of harm if it can be done safely without escalating; call for support if needed
- Call 911 immediately if the youth has already injured themselves significantly or has taken substances
- Notify the on-call supervisor immediately

### 11L.3 De-Escalation and Connection

- Use the youth's preferred name; speak in a calm, warm, slow tone
- Express genuine concern: "I'm really glad you told me. I want to understand what you're going through."
- Listen without minimizing; ask directly about safety: "Are you thinking about hurting yourself right now?" — asking directly does not increase risk
- Offer grounding strategies identified in the youth's care plan

### 11L.4 Required Notifications

| Who to Notify                                 | Timeline                                                     |
|-----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| On-call supervisor                            | Immediately                                                  |
| Program Manager                               | Within 1 hour; immediately if 911 was called                 |
| MCFD social worker or after-hours duty worker | Within 2 hours; immediately if youth transported to hospital |
| Executive Director                            | Same day for any 911 activation or hospital transport        |

### 11L.5 After the Crisis

- A Safety Plan is reviewed or created within 24 hours in collaboration with MCFD and a mental health clinician where possible
- The youth's environment is reviewed for means restriction per the updated care plan
- A Critical Incident Report is completed within 24 hours
- All involved staff are offered debrief and EFAP support within 48 hours

### 11L.6 Mandatory Reporting

A self-harm event or suicidal crisis is a Critical Incident reportable to MCFD. The MCFD notification takes precedence over internal paperwork.



## 11M. INTERNET AND COMPUTER USE POLICY

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### 11M.1 Purpose

This policy governs the appropriate use of organizational computers, tablets, internet access, and software systems by staff and youth to protect privacy, maintain data security, and ensure professional use of organizational technology.

### 11M.2 Staff Use of Organizational Technology

- Organizational devices and internet access are for work-related purposes during active shifts
- Staff log out of all organizational systems before leaving any device unattended
- Passwords are not shared with coworkers, family members, or youth
- No software or applications are installed on organizational devices without IT or Program Manager approval

### 11M.3 Youth Internet Access

- Youth internet access is provided in accordance with each youth's ISP and supervised or monitored as specified
- Youth are not given access to organizational staff accounts, documentation systems, or administrative areas of any shared device
- Age-appropriate content filtering is enabled on all devices accessible to youth
- Online activity raising safety concerns (contact with unknown adults, self-harm content) is reported to the supervisor immediately and documented

### 11M.4 Prohibited Use by Staff

- Accessing adult content, gambling sites, or sites promoting illegal activity on organizational devices
- Accessing client records using another employee's login credentials
- Taking screenshots of client documentation and transmitting them outside of secure organizational systems

### 11M.5 Privacy Breaches

Any suspected unauthorized access to organizational systems, device loss, or confidential data disclosure is reported to the Program Manager immediately. The Executive Director determines whether MCFD or the Office of the Information and Privacy Commissioner must be notified.



## 11N. MEALS, NUTRITION, AND FOOD SAFETY POLICY

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### 11N.1 Purpose

Regular, nutritious, and culturally appropriate meals are a foundation of safe, caring residential environments. This policy establishes standards for meal planning, dietary accommodation, and kitchen food safety.

### 11N.2 Meal Planning and Nutrition

- A weekly meal plan is prepared and posted in the kitchen at the beginning of each week
- Meals reflect Canada's Food Guide: proteins, vegetables, whole grains, and dairy or alternatives
- Each youth's dietary restrictions, allergies, cultural food practices, and preferences are documented in the care plan and incorporated into meal planning
- Three meals and two snacks are provided daily; no youth is denied food as a disciplinary measure
- Cultural foods meaningful to Indigenous or culturally diverse youth are incorporated into weekly menus with reasonable frequency

### 11N.3 Allergy and Medical Dietary Requirements

All food allergies and medical dietary restrictions are treated as safety-critical. They are documented in the care plan, communicated at every shift handover, and posted inside the kitchen. Staff confirm allergy information before preparing meals involving potential allergens. An EpiPen is on-site for any youth with a documented anaphylactic allergy; all staff are trained in its use.

### 11N.4 Food Safety and Hygiene

- Staff and youth wash hands with soap and water before preparing or handling food and before eating
- Refrigerator temperature maintained at or below 4°C; freezer at or below -18°C; temperatures checked and logged weekly
- Raw meat, poultry, and seafood stored on the lowest refrigerator shelf, below ready-to-eat foods, on separate cutting boards
- Leftovers covered, labeled with date and time, consumed within three (3) days or discarded
- Food left at room temperature for more than two (2) hours is discarded

### 11N.5 Youth Involvement in Meals

Age-appropriate involvement of youth in meal planning, grocery shopping, and food preparation is actively encouraged as a life skills activity. Use of sharp knives, stoves, and appliances by youth is supervised at all times.



## 110. CLOTHING, PERSONAL HYGIENE, AND LAUNDRY POLICY

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### 110.1 Purpose

Every child and youth in care has the right to clean, appropriately sized, and seasonally suitable clothing, and to receive support for personal hygiene in a manner that respects their dignity, privacy, and cultural identity.

### 110.2 Clothing

- Each youth has an adequate, personally owned supply of clothing appropriate for the season and activities
- Clothing needs are assessed at intake and at quarterly ISP reviews; any shortfalls are documented and the MCFD social worker is notified
- Youth clothing is kept in their personal space and is not shared with other residents without the youth's explicit consent
- Staff do not dispose of a youth's personal clothing without the youth's knowledge and agreement, except where items are irreparably damaged or pose a safety risk

### 110.3 Personal Hygiene

- Youth are supported, not coerced, to maintain personal hygiene routines consistent with their age, developmental level, and cultural practices
- Hygiene reminders are offered in a private, respectful, non-shaming manner
- Youth have access to personal hygiene supplies at all times; supplies are never withheld as discipline
- Staff respect cultural variations in hygiene practices, including hair care traditions for African, Caribbean, and Indigenous youth, and seek guidance from families or cultural supports where needed

### 110.4 Laundry

- Laundry facilities are available to youth on a regular schedule, with staff assistance based on age and ability
- Laundry is returned to each youth's own space promptly; personal clothing is not mixed between residents
- Bedding and towels are laundered at minimum once per week and immediately following any illness or hygiene incident



## **11P. STAFF SCHEDULING AND SHIFT MANAGEMENT POLICY**

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### **11P.1 Purpose**

Reliable, adequately staffed shifts are essential to the safety and continuity of care. This policy establishes procedures for scheduling, shift coverage, call-outs, and on-call management that protect children and youth while treating staff fairly.

### **11P.2 Schedule Development**

- Monthly schedules are published no later than the fifteenth (15th) of the preceding month
- Schedules meet the minimum staffing ratios required by MCFD licensing for each facility and program type
- Scheduling promotes continuity of care: where operationally possible, the same staff work recurring shifts with the same youth

### **11P.3 Shift Coverage and Call-Outs**

- Staff unable to attend a scheduled shift must notify their supervisor by telephone no later than two (2) hours before shift start
- The supervisor arranges replacement coverage; staff are not responsible for finding their own replacement
- Shift swaps require advance supervisor approval; swaps resulting in more than twelve (12) consecutive hours require Program Manager approval

### **11P.4 Mandatory Minimum Staffing**

No shift may proceed below the minimum MCFD-licensed staffing ratio. If a shift is at risk, the Program Manager is notified immediately. The Program Manager may extend the outgoing shift with staff agreement or contact MCFD for emergency direction. Knowingly allowing a shift to operate below licensed ratios without escalating is a serious breach of duty.

### **11P.5 On-Call Rotation**

- An on-call rotation for supervisory and senior staff is published monthly alongside the shift schedule
- On-call staff must be reachable within thirty (30) minutes and able to respond to the facility within a reasonable travel time
- On-call hours are compensated at the current on-call premium rate; hours actually worked are paid at applicable overtime rates

### **11P.6 Fatigue Prevention**

Staff must not work more than two (2) consecutive shifts without a minimum eight (8) hour break, except in genuine emergencies. Supervisors monitor for fatigue in staff who have worked extended hours and must not assign fatigued staff to high-demand situations without adequate rest.



## 20. POLICY REVIEW AND APPROVAL

### 20.1 Review Schedule

This binder is reviewed annually each July, or immediately upon:

- Amendment to BC employment legislation (Employment Standards Act, Human Rights Code, Workers Compensation Act, etc.)
- Significant organizational restructuring
- Recommendations from the Joint Health and Safety Committee or external audit
- Material changes to benefits, compensation structure, or collective agreements

### 20.2 Approval Authority

|                              |                                         |
|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| <b>Policy Owner</b>          | Director of Human Resources             |
| <b>Approved By</b>           | Board of Directors / Executive Director |
| <b>Review Responsibility</b> | Director of Human Resources             |
| <b>Legal Review</b>          | External employment counsel (as needed) |

### 20.3 Version History

| Version | Date         | Author                      | Summary of Changes               |
|---------|--------------|-----------------------------|----------------------------------|
| 1.0     | July 1, 2026 | Director of Human Resources | Initial HR Policy Binder created |

## 21. SIGNATURES AND APPROVAL

*This Human Resources Policy Binder has been developed and approved in good faith to establish fair, consistent, and legally compliant employment practices for Evergreen Community Care.*

\_\_\_\_\_  
Executive Director — Signature / Date

\_\_\_\_\_  
Director of Human Resources — Signature / Date

\_\_\_\_\_  
Board Chair (or Delegate) — Signature / Date

\_\_\_\_\_  
Date Adopted



## APPENDIX A

# New Employee Acknowledgement Form

Confirmation of Receipt and Understanding of Policies

|                    |  |
|--------------------|--|
| Employee Full Name |  |
| Position Title     |  |
| Facility / Program |  |
| Start Date         |  |

By signing below, I confirm that I have received, read, and understood the following documents:

- ☐ Human Resources Policy Binder (ECC-HR-POL-2026-001)
- ☐ Residential Care Policy Manual (ECC-RC-POL-2024-001)
- ☐ Code of Conduct (Section 11)
- ☐ Anti-Harassment and Respectful Workplace Policy (Section 12)
- ☐ Restrictive Practices Policy (Residential Care Policy Manual)
- ☐ Duty to Report obligations under the CFCSA

I understand that it is my responsibility to comply with these policies, to ask questions if anything is unclear, and to raise concerns with my supervisor or Human Resources at any time. I understand that failure to comply with these policies may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination of employment.

\_\_\_\_\_  
Employee — Signature / Date

\_\_\_\_\_  
Supervisor / HR Representative — Signature / Date



## APPENDIX B

# Confidentiality Agreement

## Protection of Confidential Information

|                    |  |
|--------------------|--|
| Employee Full Name |  |
| Position Title     |  |
| Date               |  |

As an employee of Evergreen Community Care, I will have access to confidential information regarding children, youth, families, and the organization's operations. I understand and agree to the following:

- I will not disclose any confidential information about a child, youth, or family to any unauthorized person, during or after my employment
- I will only access client information on a need-to-know basis for the purpose of fulfilling my job duties
- I will not discuss confidential information in public spaces, on social media, or with anyone outside the scope of my professional duties
- I will protect all physical and electronic records in accordance with organizational privacy policy and FOIPPA
- I will immediately report any suspected privacy breach to my supervisor or the designated Privacy Officer
- I understand this obligation continues indefinitely after my employment with Evergreen Community Care ends
- I understand that breach of confidentiality may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination, and may carry legal consequences

\_\_\_\_\_  
Employee — Signature / Date

\_\_\_\_\_  
Witness — Signature / Date



## APPENDIX C

**Annual Performance Evaluation Template**

Employee Performance Review Form

|                 |  |
|-----------------|--|
| Employee Name   |  |
| Position Title  |  |
| Review Period   |  |
| Supervisor Name |  |
| Date of Review  |  |

**Performance Areas**

|                                         |                                                       |                                |                                     |                          |
|-----------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| Quality of care and client interactions | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Cultural safety and inclusive practice  | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Documentation and record-keeping        | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Teamwork and communication              | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Training and compliance                 | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Reliability and attendance              | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Professional conduct and boundaries     | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |
| Initiative and problem-solving          | <input type="checkbox"/> Exceeds<br>Needs Improvement | <input type="checkbox"/> Meets | <input type="checkbox"/> Developing | <input type="checkbox"/> |

**Strengths****Areas for Growth**



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## Goals for Next Review Period

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## Employee Comments

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Employee — Signature / Date

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Supervisor — Signature / Date



## APPENDIX D

# Incident Investigation Report (OHS)

## Workplace Health and Safety Incident Report

|                         |  |
|-------------------------|--|
| Employee(s) Involved    |  |
| Date / Time of Incident |  |
| Location                |  |
| Reported By             |  |
| Date Reported           |  |

### Incident Type

☐ Injury    ☐ Near Miss    ☐ Property Damage    ☐ Workplace Violence    ☐ Other

### Description of Incident

---

### Immediate Actions Taken

---

### Root Cause Analysis

---

### Corrective Actions Recommended

---

|                            |  |
|----------------------------|--|
| Action Owner               |  |
| Target Completion Date     |  |
| WorkSafeBC Notified? (Y/N) |  |



|                             |  |
|-----------------------------|--|
| <b>JHSC Reviewed? (Y/N)</b> |  |
|-----------------------------|--|

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Investigator — Signature / Date

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Program Manager — Signature / Date